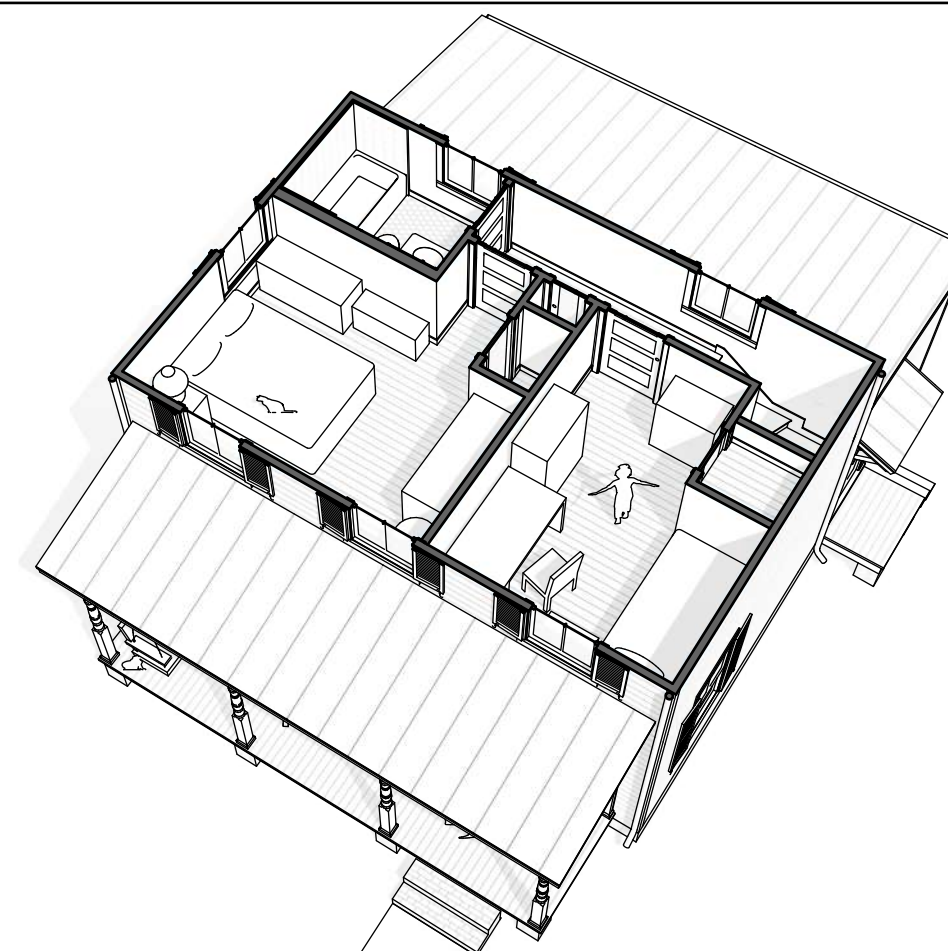


SHEET INDEX



2ND FLOOR



Today, starter homes are almost extinct. Most new houses are oversized and shortsighted—made for banks, not people. But we can avoid extreme debt by building homes that can grow.

Based on iconic house designs from the 1800s, this Starter Farmhouse is simple, economical, and versatile. It can grow beautifully with time.

Old houses did this well. They're still enduringly functional and desirable. Traditional homes can adapt to changing needs (better than the fragile fashions of modernity). To make a better future, we must build upon the successes of the past.

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PROJECT INFORMATION

LOCATION

54321 EXAMPLE AVENUE
NOWHERE, VA 12345

PROJECT DESCRIPTION

ADU OR SINGLE-FAMILY HOUSE

PROJECT NUMBER

APN 0000-0000-000-000

FLOOR AREA

1ST FLOOR: CORE: 384 SQUARE FEET
"ADDITION" (REAR): 240 SQUARE FEET
TOTAL FLOOR 1 AREA: **624 SQUARE FEET**
2ND FLOOR: **346 SQUARE FEET**

TOTAL FLOOR AREA: **970 SQUARE FEET**

CONSTRUCTION TYPE

TYPE V - WOOD FRAME CONSTRUCTION

PARCEL SIZE

[RECOMMENDED: AT LEAST 40 FEET BY 60 FEET]

APPLICABLE CODES

2022 EXAMPLE STATE BUILDING CODE

PROJECT HISTORY & CREDITS

- 2023-01-04
- 1

STARTER FARMHOUSE SCHEMATIC DESIGNS

PRESENT DIGITAL MODELS TESTING THE FIRST FOUR VARIATIONS.
- 2023-06-30
- 2

VIRGINIA: 1ST DRAFT (BASIC 16x24, 750 SQ FT)

JAY OSBORNE DESIGNS THE SMALL PROTOTYPE FOR PATREON.
- 2023-07-20
- 3

VIRGINIA: EXTENDED PLANS (REAR ADDITION)

JAY OSBORNE GIVES UPDATED PLANS TO PATREON SUPPORTERS.
- 2025-08-08
- 4

VIRGINIA: ORIGINAL DESIGN (FINISHED PLANS)

ADDED DETAILS PAGES – THANKS TO KICKSTARTER SUPPORTERS

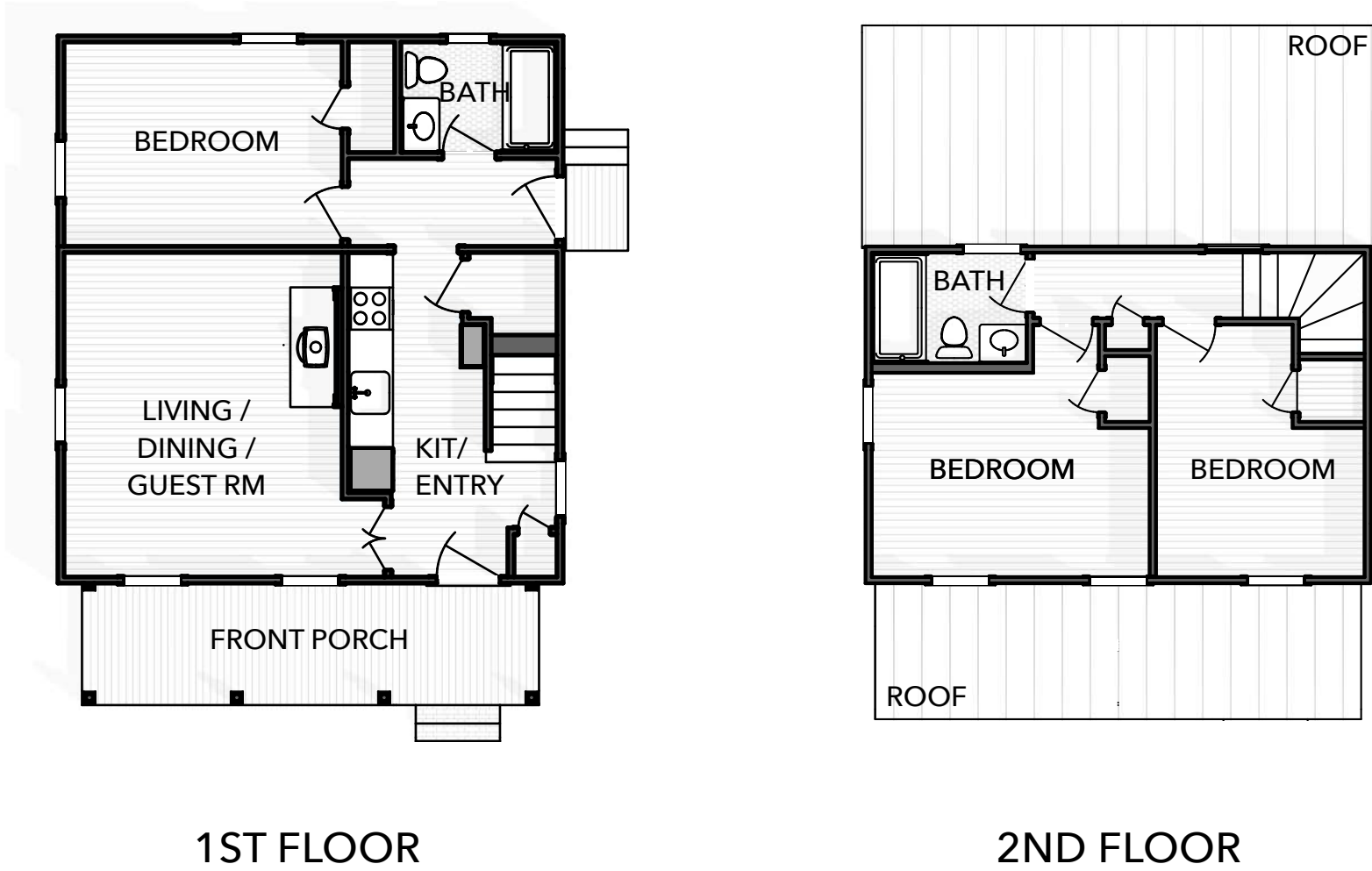
NOTES:

1. ALL WORK SO FAR IS BY JAY OSBORNE. SEE GENERAL NOTES (SHEET A0.2, SECTION 9) FOR INFORMATION ABOUT ATTRIBUTION AND THE OPEN SOURCE LICENSE.
2. THESE ARCHITECTURAL DRAWINGS ARE ONLY A TEMPLATE. FOR IT TO BE BUILT, THE DESIGN MUST BE ADAPTED TO LOCAL NEEDS & REQUIREMENTS. TO DO THIS, YOU CAN CUSTOMIZE THE SOURCE FILES (WHICH ARE FREE TO DOWNLOAD) AT FREEFARMHOUSE.COM.
3. THIS IS PART OF JAY OSBORNE’S “STARTER FARMHOUSE PROJECT”. THE FIRST DESIGNS INCLUDE *VIRGINIA*, *GEORGIA*, *CAROLINE*, AND *MARILYN*. ON PATREON.COM/FREEFARMHOUSE, YOU CAN ALSO GET EARLY ACCESS TO *DELAWARE’S*, *OREGON’S*, AND *PENNY & SYLVIA’S FARMHOUSE*– AND MANY MORE DESIGNS STILL TO COME.

PRESENTATION PLANS



VIRGINIA



CONTACT INFORMATION

OWNER

NAME
PHONE NUMBER
EMAIL ADDRESS
NOTES

STREET ADDRESS
CITY / STATE / ZIP

ARCHITECT (OR DESIGNER OF RECORD)

CONTACT PERSON
PHONE NUMBER
EMAIL ADDRESS
NOTES

COMPANY NAME
STREET ADDRESS
CITY / STATE / ZIP

GENERAL CONTRACTOR

CONTACT PERSON
PHONE NUMBER
EMAIL ADDRESS
NOTES

COMPANY NAME
STREET ADDRESS
CITY / STATE / ZIP

SURVEYOR

CONTACT PERSON
PHONE NUMBER
EMAIL ADDRESS
NOTES

COMPANY NAME
STREET ADDRESS
CITY / STATE / ZIP

PLUMBING

CONTACT PERSON
PHONE NUMBER
EMAIL ADDRESS
NOTES

COMPANY NAME
STREET ADDRESS
CITY / STATE / ZIP

MECHANICAL (AND/OR ELECTRICAL)

CONTACT PERSON
PHONE NUMBER
EMAIL ADDRESS
NOTES

COMPANY NAME
STREET ADDRESS
CITY / STATE / ZIP

STRUCTURAL

CONTACT PERSON
PHONE NUMBER
EMAIL ADDRESS
NOTES

COMPANY NAME
STREET ADDRESS
CITY / STATE / ZIP

LANDSCAPE

CONTACT PERSON
PHONE NUMBER
EMAIL ADDRESS
NOTES

COMPANY NAME
STREET ADDRESS
CITY / STATE / ZIP

INTERIORS

CONTACT PERSON
PHONE NUMBER
EMAIL ADDRESS
NOTES

COMPANY NAME
STREET ADDRESS
CITY / STATE / ZIP



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A DESIGN BY JAY OSBORNE
VIRGINIA’S FARMHOUSE
THE ORIGINAL STARTER FARMHOUSE PLANS

- 4

2025-08-08

ORIGINAL DESIGN (FINISHED PLANS)
- 3

2023-07-20

EXTENDED PLANS (REAR ADDITION)
- 2

2023-06-30

VIRGINIA: 1ST STARTER PLANS DONE
- 1

2023-01-04

STARTER FARMHOUSE SCHEMATICS
- +

See A0.1 for more project history and credits

PROJECT INFO

A0.1

GENERAL NOTES

1A – WORK SHALL CONFORM TO ALL APPLICABLE CODES AND ORDINANCES, INCLUDING BUT NOT LIMITED TO BUILDING, PLUMBING, ELECTRICAL, AND MECHANICAL CODES.

1B – ANY ERRORS, OMISSIONS, OR CONFLICTS FOUND IN THESE DRAWINGS SHALL BE BROUGHT TO THE ATTENTION OF THE OWNER OR THEIR REPRESENTATIVE BEFORE PROCEEDING WITH THE WORK.

1C – IF PRINTING FULL-SIZE DRAWING SET, DO NOT SCALE DRAWINGS.

1D – WRITTEN DIMENSIONS TAKE PRECEDENCE OVER MEASUREMENTS.

~~**1E** – METRIC DIMENSIONS DO NOT PRECISELY MATCH IMPERIAL DIMS (AS DRAWN) DUE TO DIFFERING CODES AND MODULAR STANDARDS. IF ACCURACY IS DOUBTED, IMPERIAL DIMENSIONS TAKE PRECEDENCE.~~

1F – DIMENSIONS ARE TAKEN FROM FACE OF FRAMING LUMBER, FACE OF CONCRETE/ MASONRY, CENTER/FACE OF COLUMN, AND CENTERLINE OF FIXTURE, UNLESS OTHERWISE NOTED.

1G – ALL DIMENSIONS NOTED "VERIFY IN FIELD" (V.I.F.) SHALL BE MEASURED BY THE CONTRACTOR PRIOR TO CONSTRUCTION. REPORT ANY DISCREPANCIES TO THE OWNER OR THEIR REPRESENTATIVE.

1H – ALL NOTES AND DETAILS ARE TYPICAL. SIMILAR NOTES, DETAILS, AND DIMENSIONS APPLY IN SIMILAR SITUATIONS.

1I – IN THE CASE OF DISCREPANCIES WITHIN DESCRIPTIONS OF SIMILAR ITEMS, PRECEDENCE SHALL BE GIVEN TO NOTES AND DRAWINGS OF GREATER DETAIL.

1J – INSTALL FIXTURES, MATERIALS, AND EQUIPMENT ACCORDING TO MANUFACTURERS' SPECIFICATIONS. SHOULD THOSE SPECS CONFLICT WITH THE DRAWINGS, OR VIOLATE LOCAL REGULATIONS, IMMEDIATELY NOTIFY THE OWNER OR THEIR REPRESENTATIVE.

1K – VERIFY CLEARANCES FOR FIXTURES, VENTS, CHASES, ETC. BEFORE ORDERING OR INSTALLING RELATED WORK ITEMS.

1L – COORDINATE ALL WORK WITH EXISTING CONDITIONS, INCLUDING BUT NOT LIMITED TO: IRRIGATION PIPES, ELECTRICAL CONDUITS, WATER LINES, GAS LINES, AND DRAINAGE LINES.

1M – IT IS BEYOND THE SCOPE OF ARCHITECTURAL DRAWINGS TO ILLUSTRATE THE BUILDING CODE. BUILDERS: READ IT, FOLLOW IT.

2 (SITE / FOUNDATION)

2A – ANY SURVEY MARKERS WITHIN THE AREA OF CONSTRUCTION SHALL BE PRESERVED OR RESET BY A REGISTERED CIVIL ENGINEER OR LICENSED LAND SURVEYOR.

2B – GRADING AND SITEWORK SHALL BE MINIMAL IN ALL AREAS NOT DIRECTLY AFFECTED BY THE NEW CONSTRUCTION. FOLLOW BEST PRACTICES AND LOCAL REQUIREMENTS IN ORDER TO MINIMIZE ENVIRONMENTAL DAMAGE.

2C – FINISH GRADE SHALL SLOPE DOWN FROM HOUSE, AT A HEIGHT OF 6 INCHES OVER A 10 FOOT DISTANCE.

2D – BEFORE GRADING OPERATIONS, A TEMPORARY PROTECTION FENCE SHALL BE CONSTRUCTED AROUND ANY TREE WITHIN 30 FEET OF THE FOUNDATION. SILT FENCES SHALL BE CONSTRUCTED DOWNSLOPE OF ANY AREA WHERE THE SOIL IS DISTURBED.

2E – DEPICTED FOUNDATION IS BASED ON FICTIONAL CONDITIONS. CONDUCT A SOIL TEST AND STRUCTURAL ENGINEERING FOR A SITE-SPECIFIC FOUNDATION. (AND THEN YOU CAN DELETE THIS NOTE)

2F – FOOTINGS SHALL EXTEND BELOW THE LOCAL FROST LINE.

2G – PERFORATED DRAINAGE PIPES SHALL BE LOCATED WITHIN A GRAVEL PERIMETER AROUND THE FOUNDATION; AND MULTIPLE DRAINAGE OUTLETS LEAD DOWNSLOPE AWAY FROM THE BUILDING.

2H – ALL WOOD WITHIN 8 INCHES OF THE GROUND SHALL BE PRESSURE TREATED OR COMPRISE A SUITABLY ROT RESISTANT MATERIAL. METAL CONNECTIONS WHICH TOUCH THIS WOOD SHOULD BE GALVANIZED OR STAINLESS STEEL.

3 (CONSTRUCTION)

3A – ALL CONSTRUCTION SHALL BE TRUE, PLUMB, LEVEL, SQUARE, AND IN PROPER ALIGNMENT.

3B – THE GENERAL CONTRACTOR SHALL MAINTAIN A CURRENT AND COMPLETE FULL-SIZE SET OF DRAWINGS ON THE JOB SITE DURING ALL PHASES OF CONSTRUCTION. ALL SUBCONTRACTORS SHALL BE PROVIDED WITH A SET OF DRAWINGS.

3C – THE GENERAL CONTRACTOR SHALL VERIFY AND ASSUME RESPONSIBILITY FOR ALL DIMENSIONS AND SITE CONDITIONS, AS WELL AS INSPECT THE PREMISES AND TAKE NOTE OF EXISTING CONDITIONS PRIOR TO SUBMITTING PRICES. NO CLAIM SHALL BE ALLOWED FOR PROBLEMS FREEFARMHOUSE.COM WHICH COULD HAVE BEEN PREVENTED BY A THOROUGH EXAMINATION.

3A – PROVIDE TEMPORARY SUPPORT AS NECESSARY TO ENSURE THE STRUCTURAL INTEGRITY OF THE BUILDING UNDER CONSTRUCTION. THE GENERAL CONTRACTOR IS RESPONSIBLE FOR ALL CONSTRUCTION-RELATED ACTIVITIES.

3D – THE GENERAL CONTRACTOR SHALL BE RESPONSIBLE FOR REGULARLY REMOVING THE WASTE MATERIALS OF ALL SUBCONTRACTORS, AND MAINTAIN STRICT CONTROL OVER JOB CLEANING TO PREVENT DUST AND RUBBISH FROM INTERFERING WITH OPERATIONS.

3E – CONSTRUCTION EQUIPMENT NOISE SHALL BE MINIMIZED DURING THE CONSTRUCTION PHASES BY MUFFLING AND SHIELDING IMPACT TOOLS WHENEVER POSSIBLE.

3F – IF THE WORK OF ANY CONTRACTOR SIGNIFICANTLY DEVIATES FROM THE CONTRACT DRAWINGS WITHOUT THEM FIRST GETTING PERMISSION FROM THE APPROPRIATE PERSON, THAT CONTRACTOR MAY BE REQUIRED TO FIX THEIR WORK AT THEIR OWN EXPENSE.

4 (UTILITIES)

4A – ANY ELECTRICAL, PLUMBING AND/OR HVAC SYSTEMS INCLUDED IN THE WORK SHALL BE INSTALLED ON A DESIGN-BUILD BASIS, AND SHALL NOT SIGNIFICANTLY ALTER THE STRUCTURE OR FINISHES.

5 (WEATHERPROOFING)

5A – CHECK LOCAL CODES FOR INSULATION REQUIREMENTS.

5B – AVOID USING SPRAY FOAM INSULATION WITHOUT MITIGATING MOISTURE ISSUES & THE POSSIBILITY OF HIDDEN STRUCTURAL ROT.

5C – DEPICTED WEATHERPROOFING METHODS (SUCH AS SEALANT, CAULKING, AND FLASHING) ARE NOT COMPREHENSIVE. FOLLOW REQ'TS OF BUILDING CODES, PRODUCT MANUFACTURERS, ETC.

6 (EGRESS / FIRE SAFETY)

6A – FIRE BLOCKING AND FIRE-RATED SHEATHING SHALL BE PROVIDED AS REQUIRED AT CEILINGS, FLOORS, AND ENCLOSED USABLE SPACE UNDER STAIRS.

6B – SMOKE DETECTORS AND CARBON MONOXIDE DETECTORS SHALL BE INSTALLED PER APPLICABLE CODES.

6C – ALL GLASS SHALL CONFORM WITH HUMAN IMPACT AND SAFETY REQUIREMENTS.

6D – ALL REQUIRED EXITS SHALL BE OPERABLE FROM THE INSIDE, WITHOUT THE USE OF A KEY OR ANY SPECIAL KNOWLEDGE.

6E – AT STAIRS, TREADS SHALL BE 10" MINIMUM, AND RISERS 7.75" MAXIMUM, WITH A MAXIMUM 3/8" VARIATION WITHIN A FLIGHT.

6F – HANDRAILS SHALL BE LOCATED 34-38 INCHES [864-965 MM] ABOVE STAIR TREADS AS MEASURED FROM THE NOSINGS.

6G – GUARDRAILS MUST BE LOCATED ALONG ANY EDGE WHERE THE FLOOR DROPS 30" [762] OR MORE TO THE FLOOR OR GROUND BELOW.

7 (FINISHES & FIXTURES)

7A – PROVIDE ADEQUATE BLOCKING AROUND CABINETY, PLUMBING FIXTURES, AND OTHER APPLICABLE AREAS.

7B – CONTRACTOR MUST ENSURE THE INTERIOR SHEATHING IS FLUSH, CLEAN AND FREE OF DUST AND DEFECTS BEFORE THE APPLICATION OF PAINT COATINGS

7C – FLOOR MATERIAL TRANSITIONS OCCUR AT THE CENTERLINE OF DOORS OR FRAMED OPENINGS.

7D – PROVIDE AT LEAST 1 COAT PRIMER AND 2 FINISH COATS OF PAINT AT INTERIOR AND EXTERIOR SURFACES.

7E – DO NOT USE SCREW-ON, NON-OPERABLE WINDOW SHUTTERS. THEY ARE AS TACKY AS CLIP-ON TIES.

7F – AN ECONOMICAL ALTERNATIVE TO LOUVERED SHUTTERS: BOARD & BATTEN SHUTTERS. BUT DO NOT USE SCREW-ON, NON-OPERABLE SHUTTERS. (IT WOULD BE BETTER TO USE NONE AT ALL.)

7G – DO NOT USE ALUMINUM OR VINYL SIDING. SNAP-ON SIDING MAKES ONCE-BEAUTIFUL HOUSES LOOK LIKE CHEAP PLASTIC TOYS.

7H – SCREEN PORCHES MAY BECOME FUTURE ADDITIONS TO THE CONDITIONED SPACE (AS A MUDROOM, BATHROOM TO A BEDROOM SUITE, ETC). BUILD THEM WITH THAT IN MIND.

7I – WALL-TO-WALL CARPETING IS FORBIDDEN.

9 (CONDITIONS OF USE)

9A – JAY OSBORNE IS THE ORIGINAL DESIGNER OF THIS WORK. INSTEAD OF A CONVENTIONAL COPYRIGHT, HE PROVIDES THESE PLANS UNDER AN OPEN SOURCE LICENSE. SOME RIGHTS RESERVED.

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9H – APPROPRIATE CREDIT INCLUDES MENTIONING JAY OSBORNE IS THE ORIGINAL DESIGNER. SPECIFY THAT WHERE AND WHEN IT WOULD BE IMPORTANT FOR SOMEBODY. (IF THEY WOULD FEEL SCAMMED WHEN LEARNING THE TRUTH, THEN YOU DID IT WRONG.) ALSO MENTION ANY CHANGES YOU MADE, IF APPLICABLE– BUT DON'T IMPLY JAY OSBORNE HAD ENDORSED THEM.

9I – THESE DRAWINGS ARE DERIVED FROM SKETCHUP MODELS, WHICH CAN BE DOWNLOADED FOR FREE ONLINE.

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THE ORIGINAL STARTER FARMHOUSE PLANS

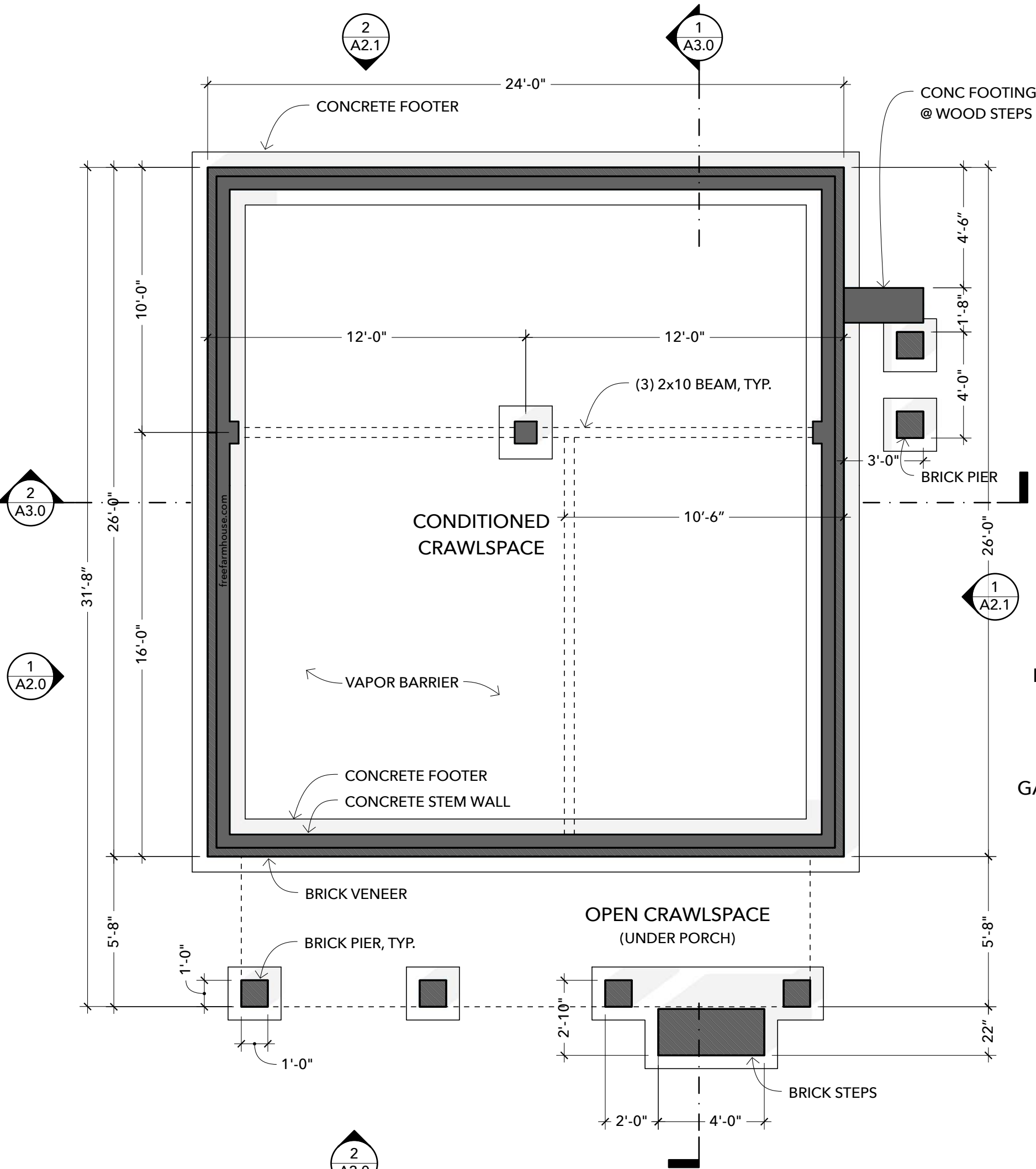
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+ See A0.1 for more project history and credits

GENERAL NOTES

A0.2

FOUNDATION PLAN NOTES:

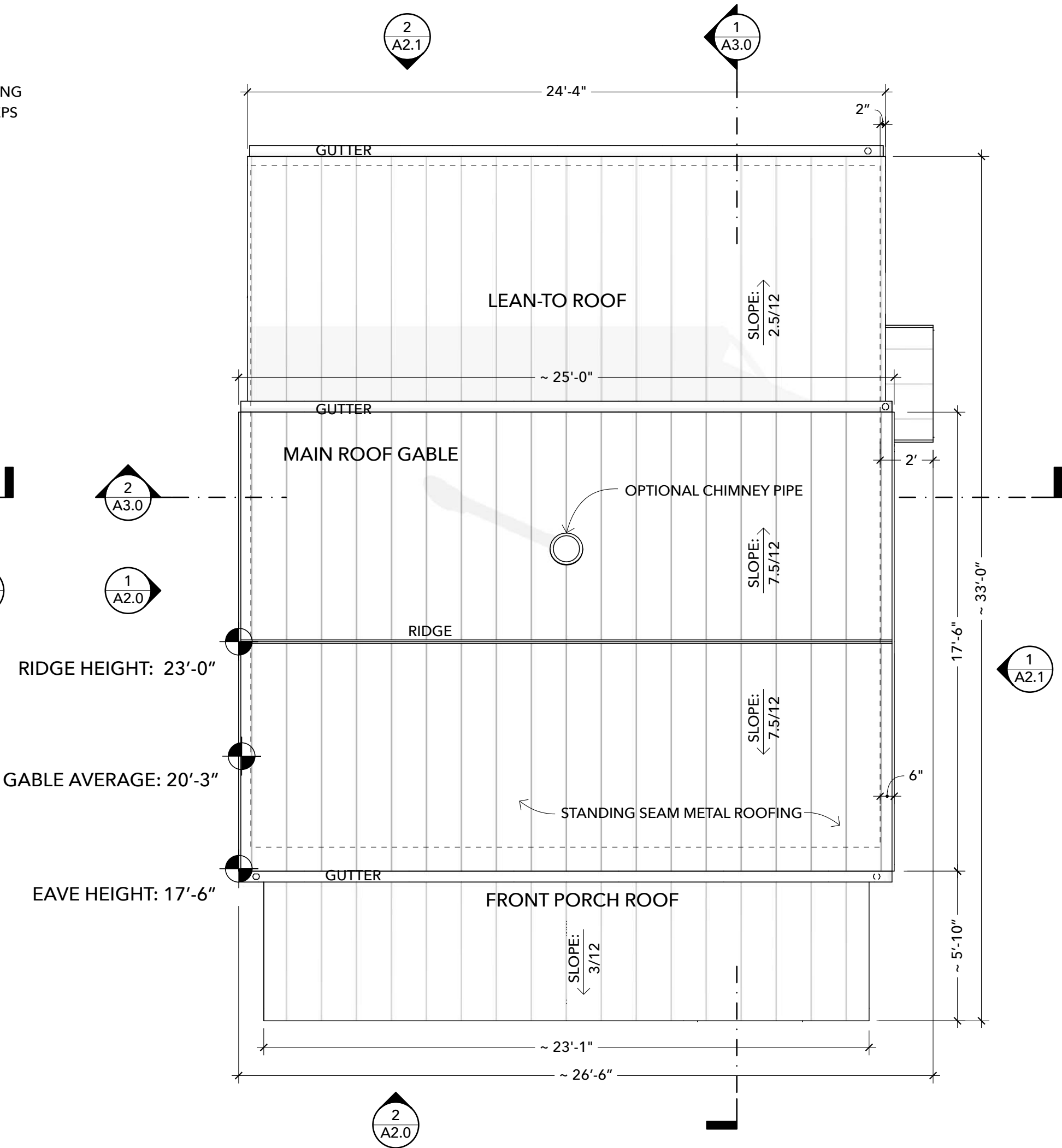
1. ALL FOUNDATION DESIGNS MUST BE ENGINEERED TO LOCAL CONDITIONS. THIS IS ONLY A TEMPLATE. INSTEAD OF A CONDITIONED CRAWLSPACE, IT COULD BE AN OPEN CRAWLSPACE (PIER FOUNDATION), SLAB, OR A BASEMENT.
2. STRUCTURAL BRICK FACING MAY BE THIN BRICK VENEER INSTEAD. OTHERWISE, EXPOSED CONCRETE WORKS FINE.



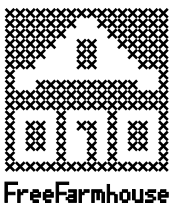
1 FOUNDATION PLAN
SCALE: 1/4" = 1'-0"

ROOF PLAN NOTES:

1. DATUMS ARE TO FINISH FLOOR. BUILDING HEIGHTS ARE OFTEN MEASURED TO GRADE, BUT THERE ARE MANY WAYS TO MEASURE THEM. THIS DESIGN CAN EASILY WORK WITHIN A 25' HEIGHT LIMIT.
2. TO SAVE COSTS, 5V GALVALUME ROOF PANELS MAY BE USED INSTEAD OF STANDING SEAM ROOFING.



2 ROOF PLAN
SCALE: 1/4" = 1'-0"



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FOUNDATION/ ROOF
A1.0

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FLOOR PLAN NOTES:

1. IF MORE THAN 3 RISERS ARE NEEDED AT PORCH STEPS, A HANDRAIL SHOULD BE PROVIDED (AS REQ'D BY CODE).
1. GUARDRAIL MAY BE REQUIRED AT PORCH IF DROP TO GROUND IS INCREASED TO MORE THAN 24-30" (SEE LOCAL REQ'TS).
3. IF THE HOUSE NEEDS A BASEMENT, THE STAIRS DOWNWARD WILL BE LOCATED WHERE THE UTILITY CLOSET IS NOW. STACK THE STAIRCASES.

DOORS

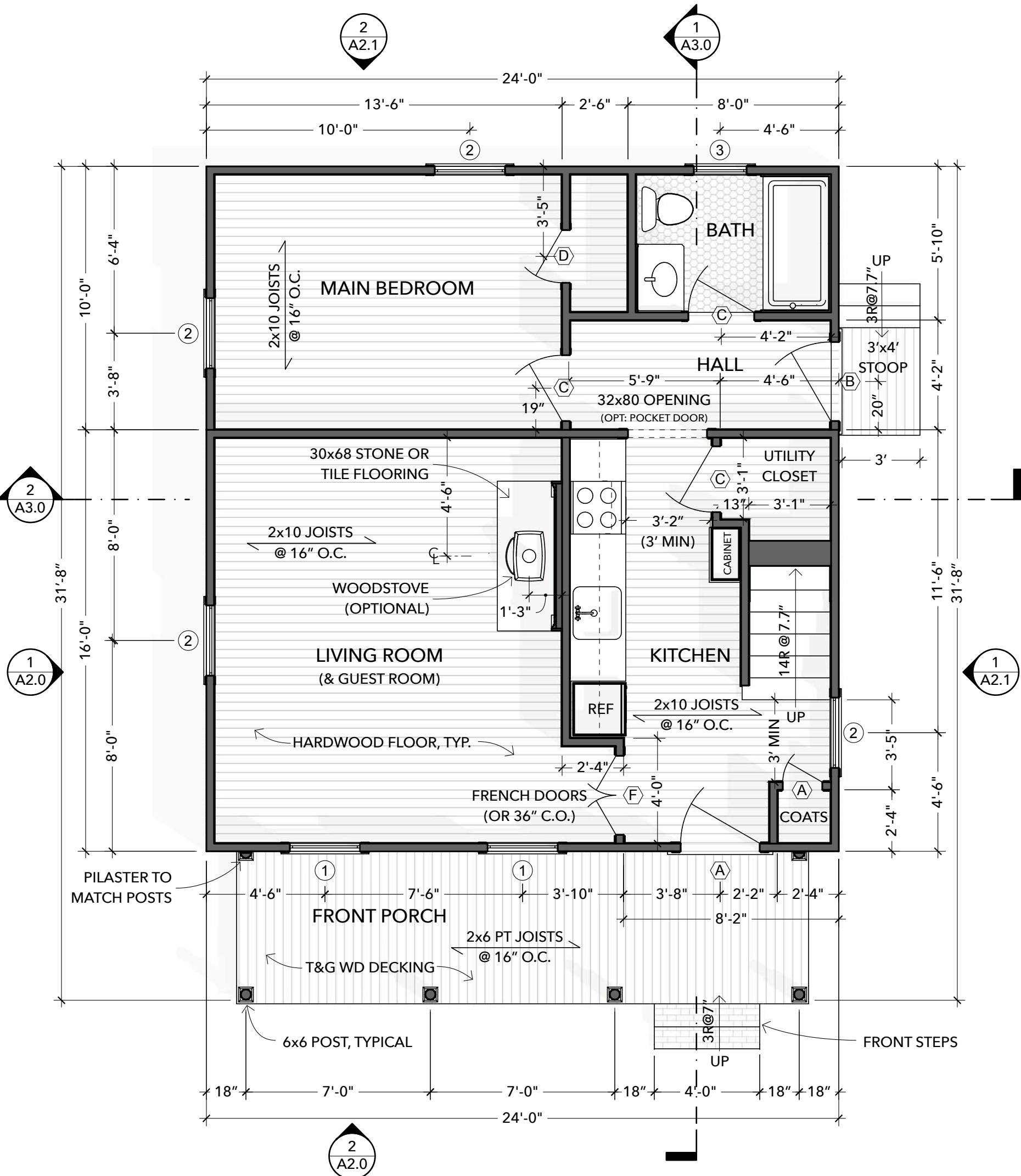
- (A) 36x84 9-LITE FRONT DOOR
(B) 36x80 4-LITE BACK DOOR
(C) 30x80 5-PANEL DOOR
(D) 24x80 1-PANEL DOOR
(E) 18x80 LOUVERED DOOR
(F) (2) 18x80 FRENCH DOORS

WINDOWS

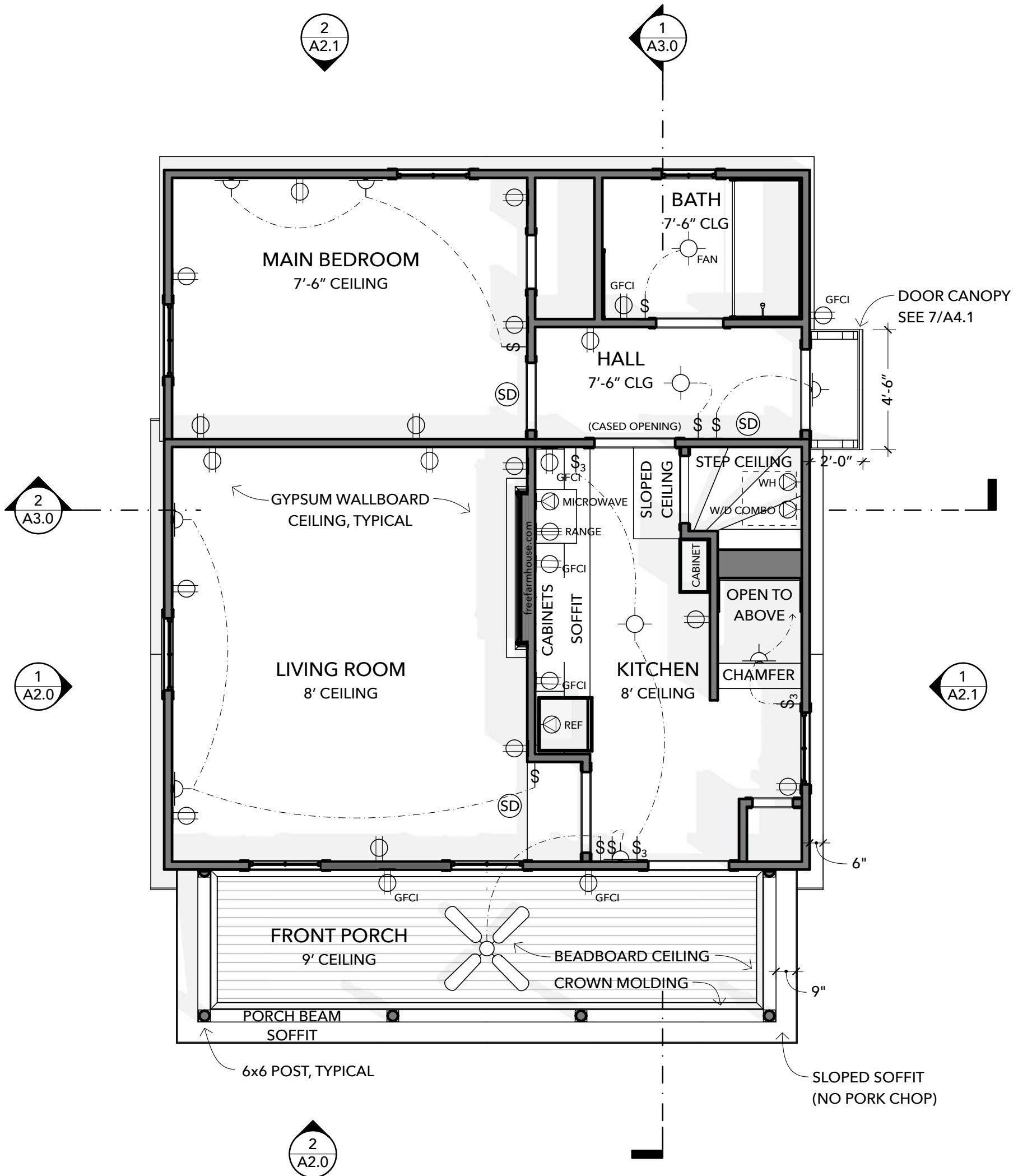
- (1) 32x72 DH 2/2 DIVIDED LITES
(2) 32x60 DH 2/2 DIVIDED LITES
(3) 24x48 DH 2/2 DIVIDED LITES

CEILING/ ELECTRICAL NOTES:

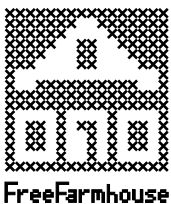
1. CEILING HEIGHTS ARE APPROXIMATE (+/- 1")
2. UTILITY ROOM CEILING SHALL BE FIRE-RATED WITH GYP BD SHEATHING
3. HEAD CLEARANCE AT STAIRCASE TO BE 80" MINIMUM



1 1ST FLOOR PLAN
SCALE: 1/4" = 1'-0"



2 1ST LEVEL - REFLECTED CEILING PLAN / ELECTRICAL PLAN
SCALE: 1/4" = 1'-0"



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DOWNSTAIRS PLANS

A1.1

FLOOR PLAN NOTES:

1. WINDER STAIRS MUST FOLLOW STRICT CODES. THEY ARE SAFER THAN IN THE PAST, BUT NOW HARDER TO BUILD.
2. BEDROOM CLOSET W/ RAISED PLATFORM AT STAIRS MAY BE OMITTED. MOST IMPORTANTLY: ENSURE ADEQUATE HEADROOM AT STAIRCASE.
3. LINEN CLOSET (AT HALL) MAY INSTEAD BE A CHASE FOR DUCTWORK AND/OR AN INSULATED CHIMNEY PIPE.
4. MAIN BEDROOM CLOSET MAY BE REPLACED BY A WARDROBE.

DOORS

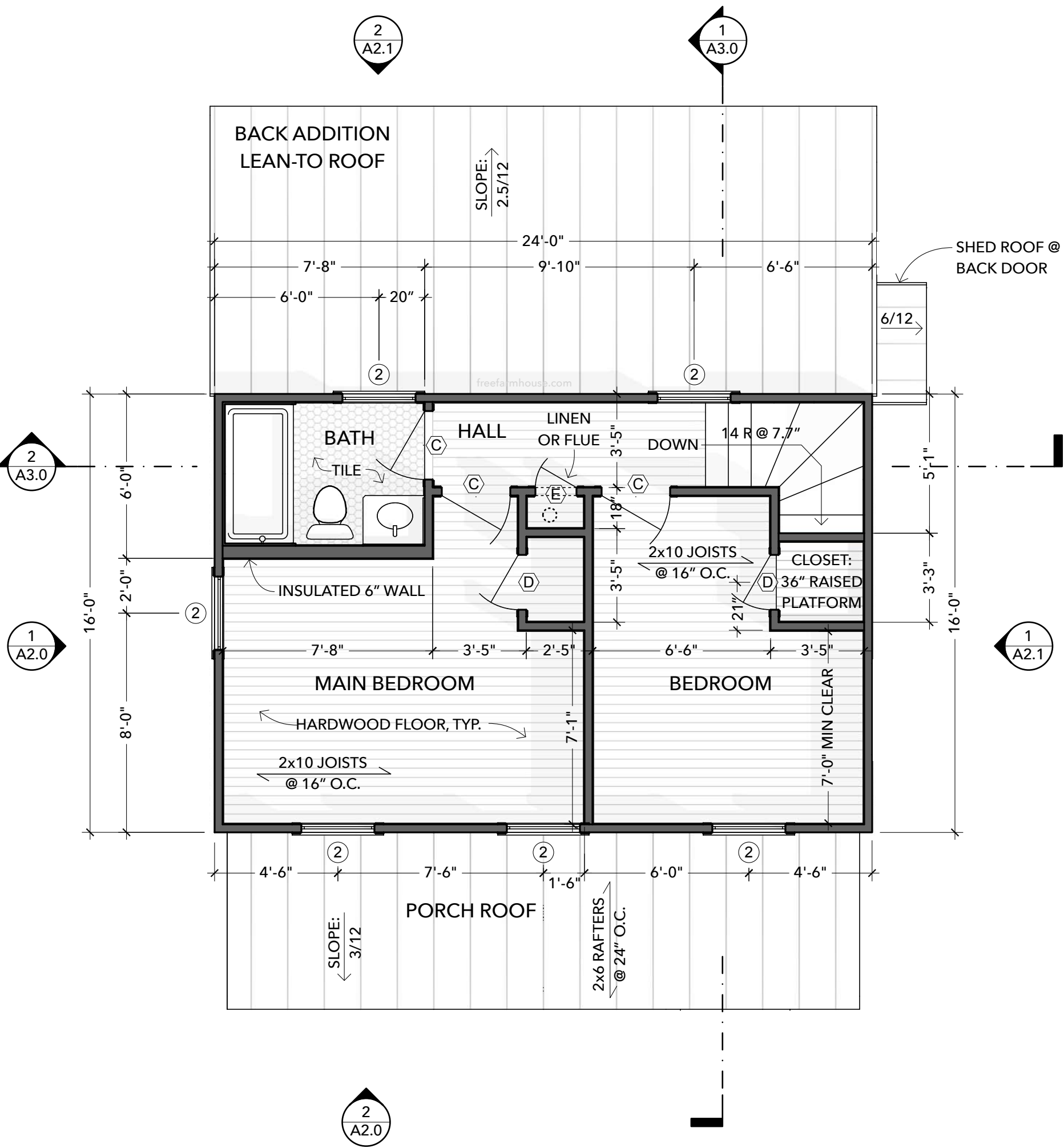
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- (E) 18x80 LOUVERED DOOR
- (F) (2) 18x80 FRENCH DOORS

WINDOWS

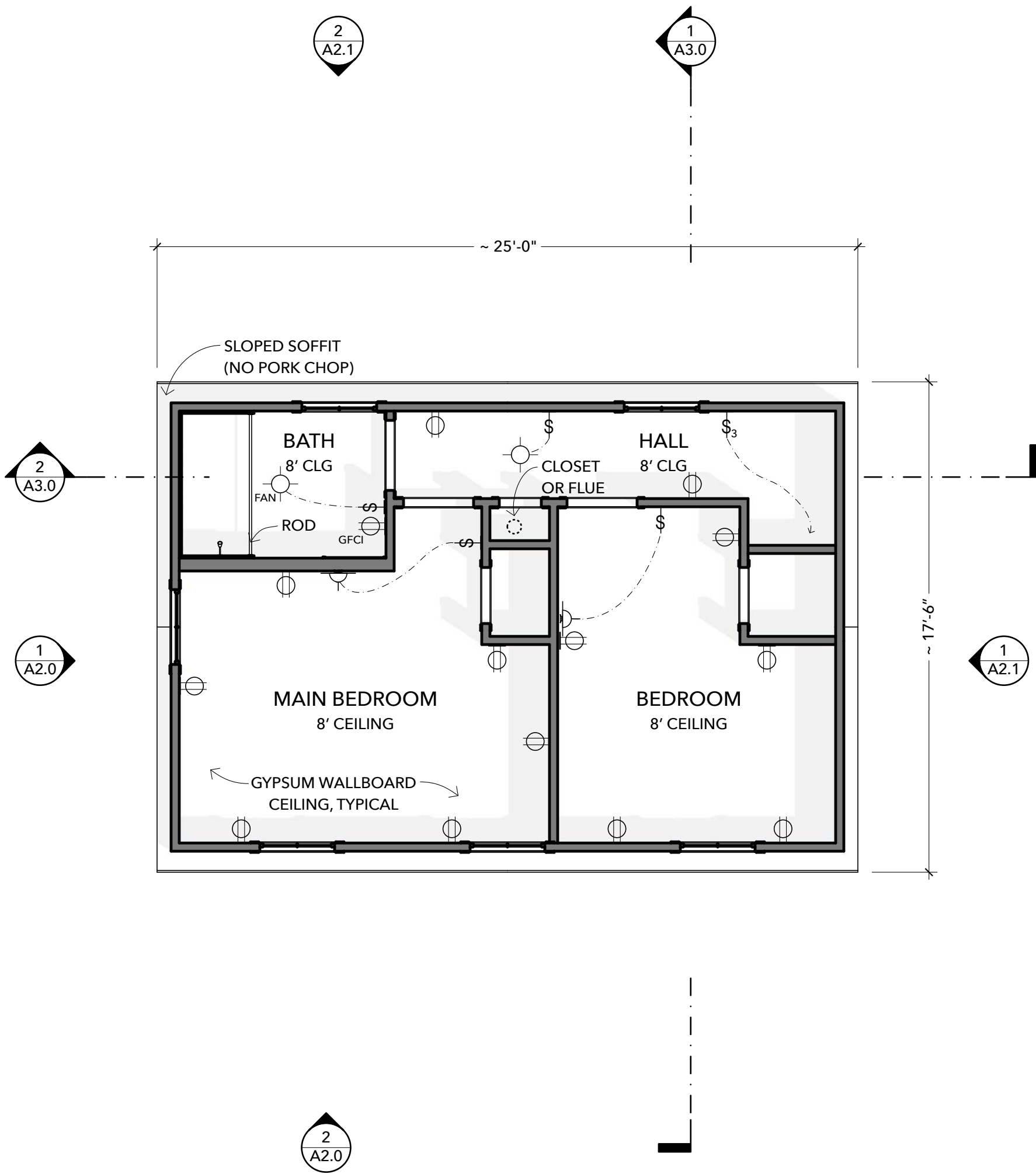
- (1) 32x72 DH 2/2 DIVIDED LITES
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CEILING PLAN NOTES:

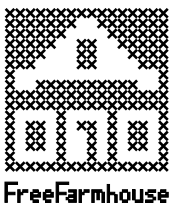
1. CEILING HEIGHTS ARE APPROXIMATE (+/- 1"). PRIORITIZE DIMENSIONS SHOWN IN SECTION DRAWINGS.
2. HEAD CLEARANCE AT STAIRCASE TO BE 80" MINIMUM
3. WALL-MOUNTED LIGHTS ARE PREFERRED WHEREVER EFFICIENCY AND STERILITY ARE NOT VIRTUES.



1 2ND FLOOR PLAN
SCALE: 1/4" = 1'-0"



2 2ND LEVEL - REFLECTED CEILING PLAN / ELECTRICAL PLAN
SCALE: 1/4" = 1'-0"



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UPSTAIRS PLANS

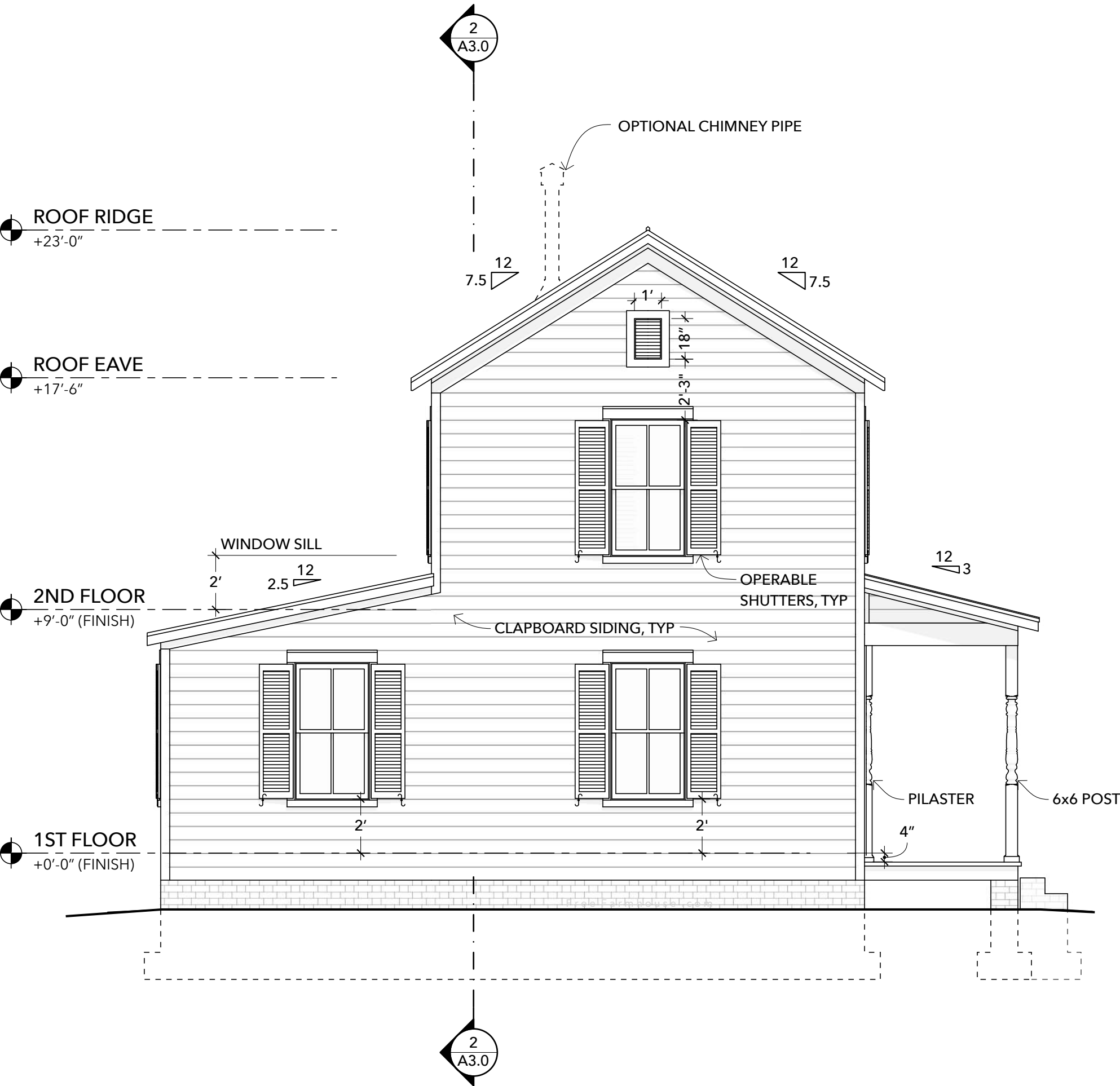
A1.2

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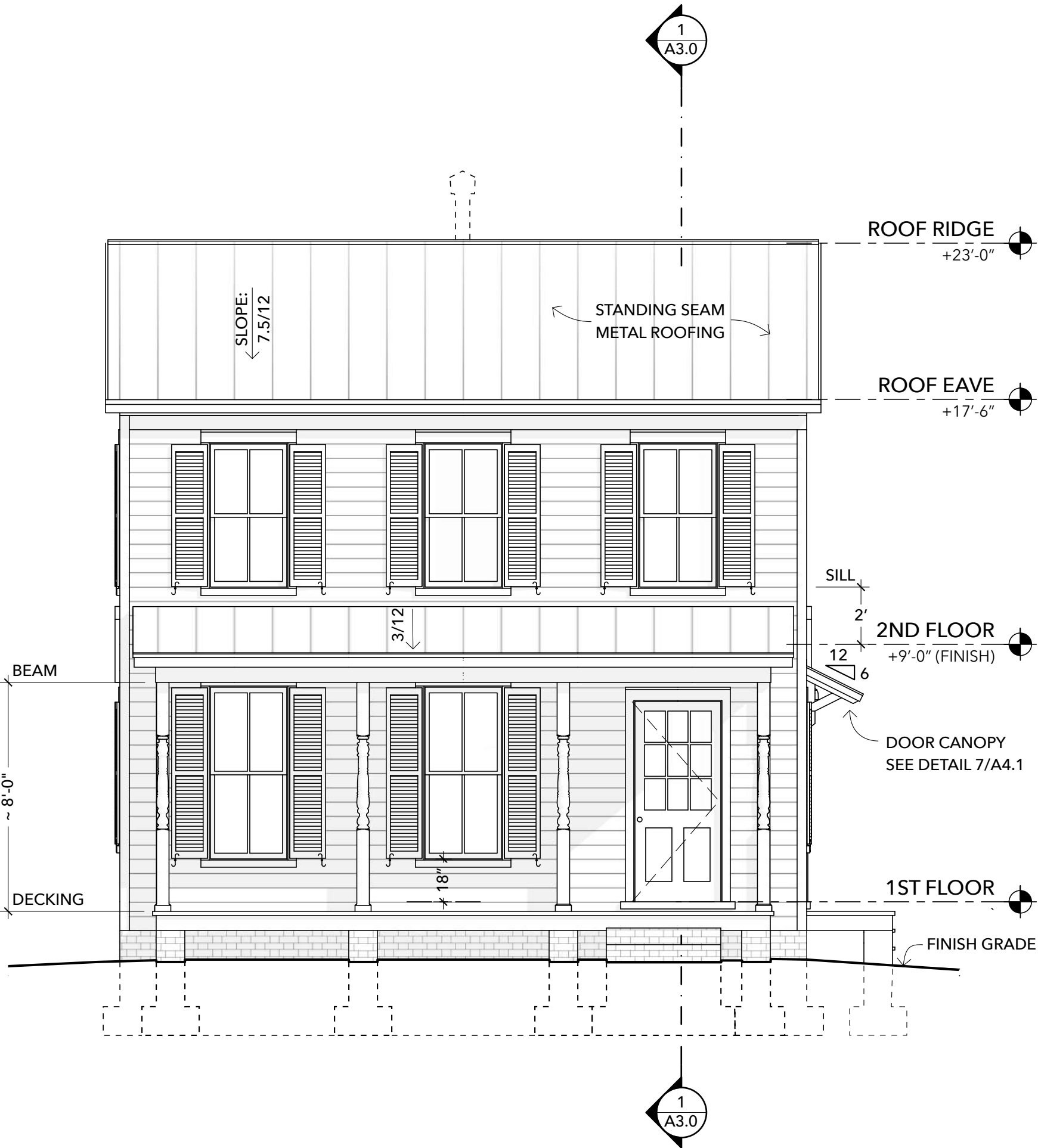
ELEVATION NOTES

- 1. DATUMS ARE TO FINISH FLOOR. BUILDING HEIGHT IS OFTEN MEASURED TO GRADE. THEREFORE, THIS DESIGN WORKS WITH AN 20-FOOT HEIGHT RESTRICTION (GABLE AVERAGE) OR A 25-FOOT HEIGHT RESTRICTION (ROOF RIDGE TO GRADE).
- 2. SECTION DIMENSIONS TAKE PRECEDENCE, WHEREVER PRECISION IS DEMANDED.
- 3. USE REAL, OPERABLE SHUTTERS– OR NONE AT ALL. PLASTIC TACK-ON SHUTTERS ARE AS CORNY AS CLIP-ON TIES. THIS IS A HOUSE, NOT A CHEAP PLASTIC TOY.
- 4. DO NOT “PORK CHOP” ANY OF THE ROOF EAVES.

- 5. **DOORS:** MARVIN ULTIMATE SERIES. BUT ANTIQUES PREFERRED. TRIM: WOOD OR FIBER CEMENT: 1x4 SIDE, 2x6 UPPER (W/ EXPOSED FLASHING), 3” SILL.
- 6. **WINDOWS:** DOUBLE HUNG W/ 2/2 DIVIDED LITES, MARVIN ULTIMATE SERIES, OR ANTIQUE. TRIM: SOLID WOOD OR FIBER CEMENT: 1x4 SIDE, 2x6 UPPER, 3” SILL.
- 7. **SIDING:** 4-6” FIBER CEMENT CLAPBOARD. JAMES HARDIE: ARTISAN SERIES. OTHER OPTIONS: WOOD, SHINGLES, BOARD & BATTEN. BUT VINYL SIDING IS FORBIDDEN.
- 8. **ROOFING:** STANDING SEAM METAL PANELS (16”). IF BUDGET ALLOWS: WOOD SHINGLES OR SLATE. TO SAVE COSTS: USE 5V GALVALUME PANELS OR ROUND CORRUGATED STEEL. DON’T USE METAL PANELS WITH SQUARE-ISH CORRUGATIONS.



1 WEST ELEVATION (SIDE)
SCALE: 1/4" = 1'-0"



2 SOUTH ELEVATION (FRONT)
SCALE: 1/4" = 1'-0"



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A DESIGN BY JAY OSBORNE
VIRGINIA'S FARMHOUSE
THE ORIGINAL STARTER FARMHOUSE PLANS

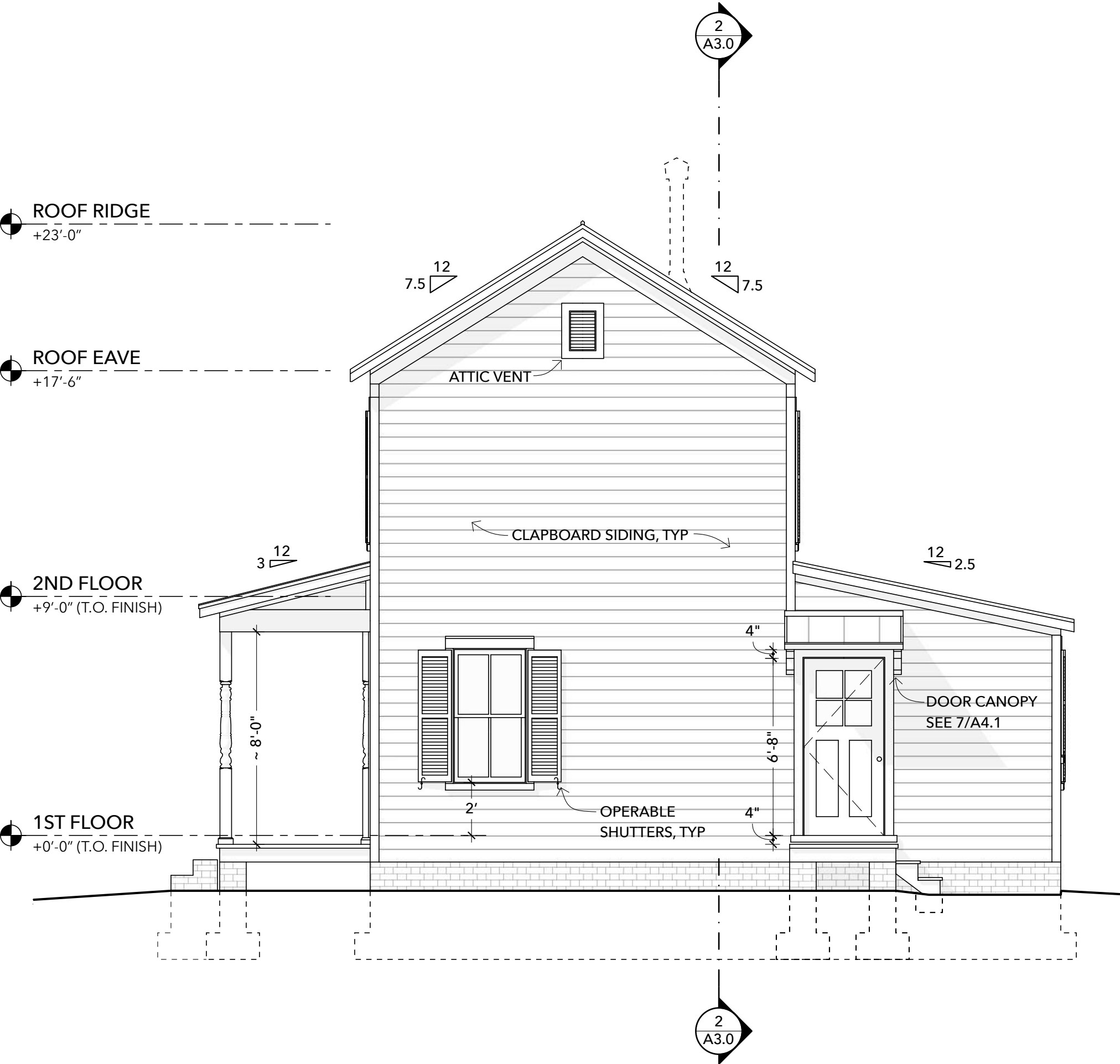
- 4 2025-08-08 ORIGINAL DESIGN (FINISHED PLANS)
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- + See A0.1 for more project history and credits

FRONT ELEVATIONS
A2.0

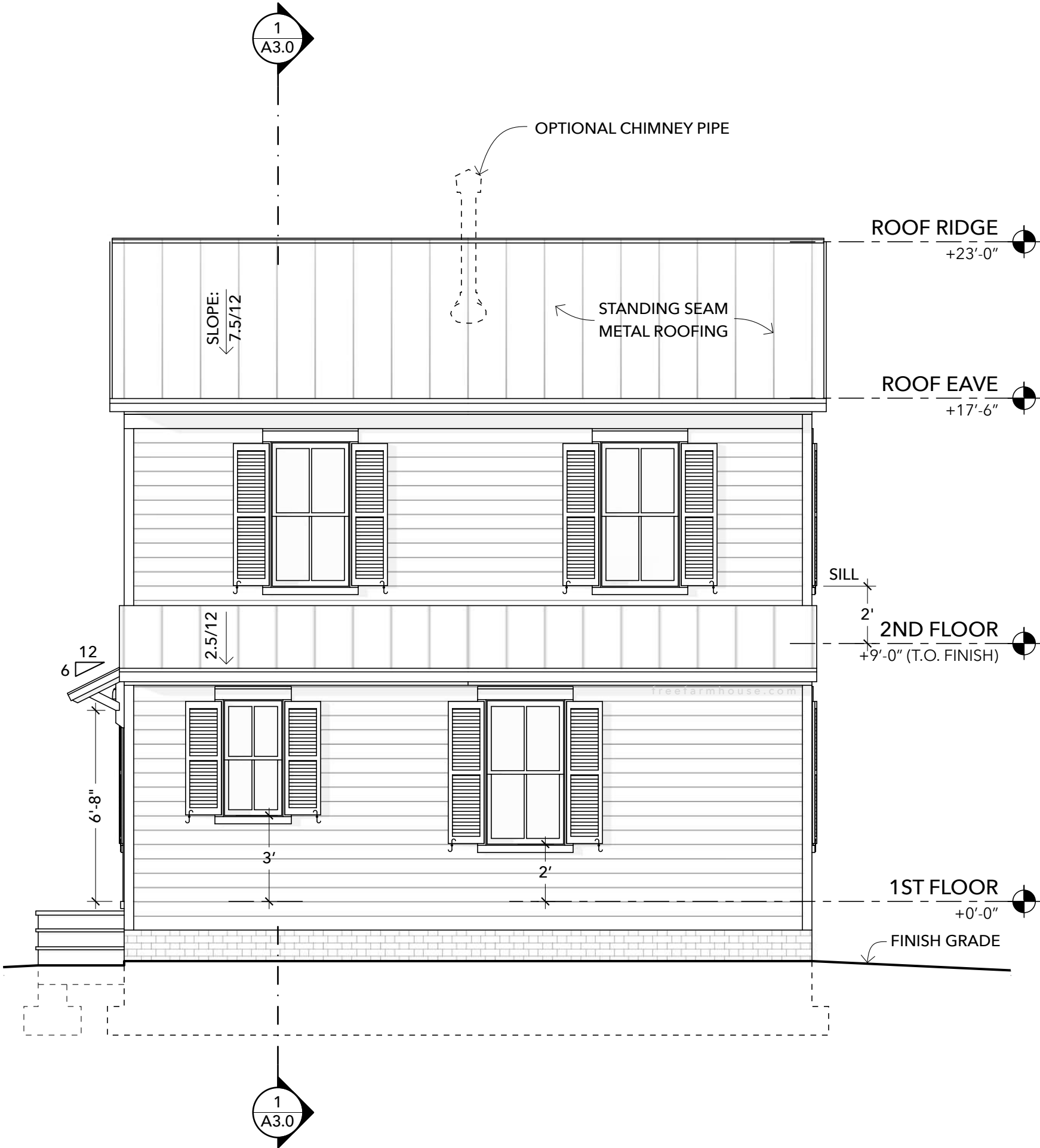
ELEVATION NOTES

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- 2. SECTION DIMENSIONS TAKE PRECEDENCE, WHEREVER PRECISION IS DEMANDED.
- 3. SOME DETAILS IN THE REAR ELEVATIONS CAN BE SIMPLIFIED, SINCE THEY ARE LESS FORMAL AND LESS VISIBLE. FOR INSTANCE, WINDOW SHUTTERS MAY BE OMITTED. IT'S BETTER TO HAVE NO SHUTTERS THAN CORNY, USELESS, TACK-ON PLASTIC ONES.
- 4. DO NOT "PORK CHOP" ANY OF THE ROOF EAVES.

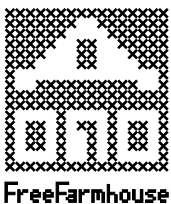
- 5. **DOORS:** MARVIN ULTIMATE SERIES. BUT ANTIQUES PREFERRED. TRIM: WOOD OR FIBER CEMENT: 1x4 SIDE, 2x6 UPPER (W/ EXPOSED FLASHING), 3" SILL.
- 6. **WINDOWS:** DOUBLE HUNG W/ 2/2 DIVIDED LITES, MARVIN ULTIMATE SERIES, OR ANTIQUE. TRIM: SOLID WOOD OR FIBER CEMENT: 1x4 SIDE, 2x6 UPPER, 3" SILL.
- 7. **SIDING:** 4-6" FIBER CEMENT CLAPBOARD. JAMES HARDIE: ARTISAN SERIES. OTHER OPTIONS: WOOD, SHINGLES, BOARD & BATTEN. BUT VINYL SIDING IS FORBIDDEN.
- 8. **ROOFING:** STANDING SEAM METAL PANELS (16"). IF BUDGET ALLOWS: WOOD SHINGLES OR SLATE. TO SAVE COSTS: USE 5V GALVALUME PANELS OR ROUND CORRUGATED STEEL. DON'T USE METAL PANELS WITH SQUARE-ISH CORRUGATIONS.



1 EAST ELEVATION (SIDE)
SCALE: 1/4" = 1'-0"



2 NORTH ELEVATION (BACK)
SCALE: 1/4" = 1'-0"



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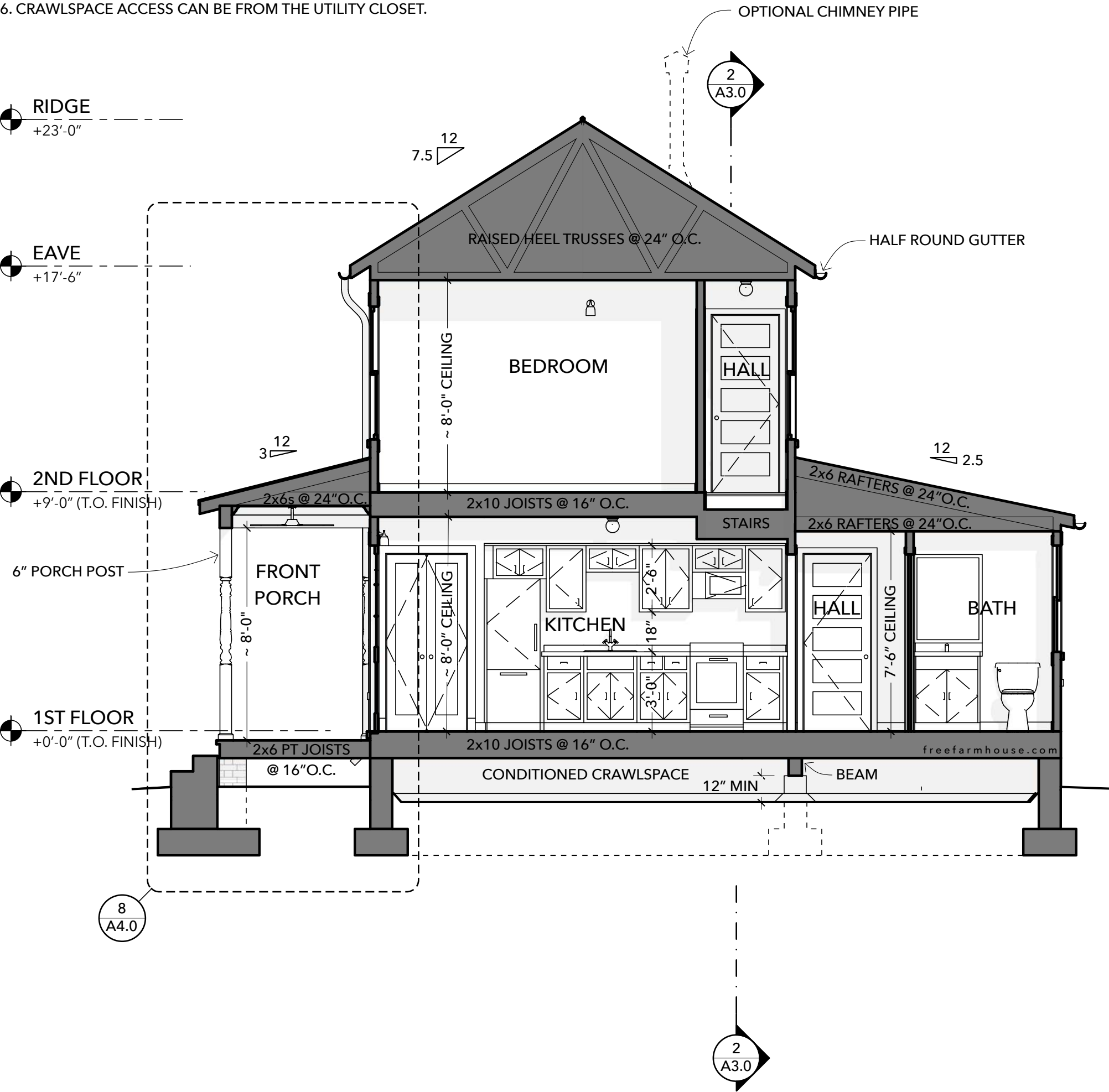
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REAR ELEVATIONS
A2.1

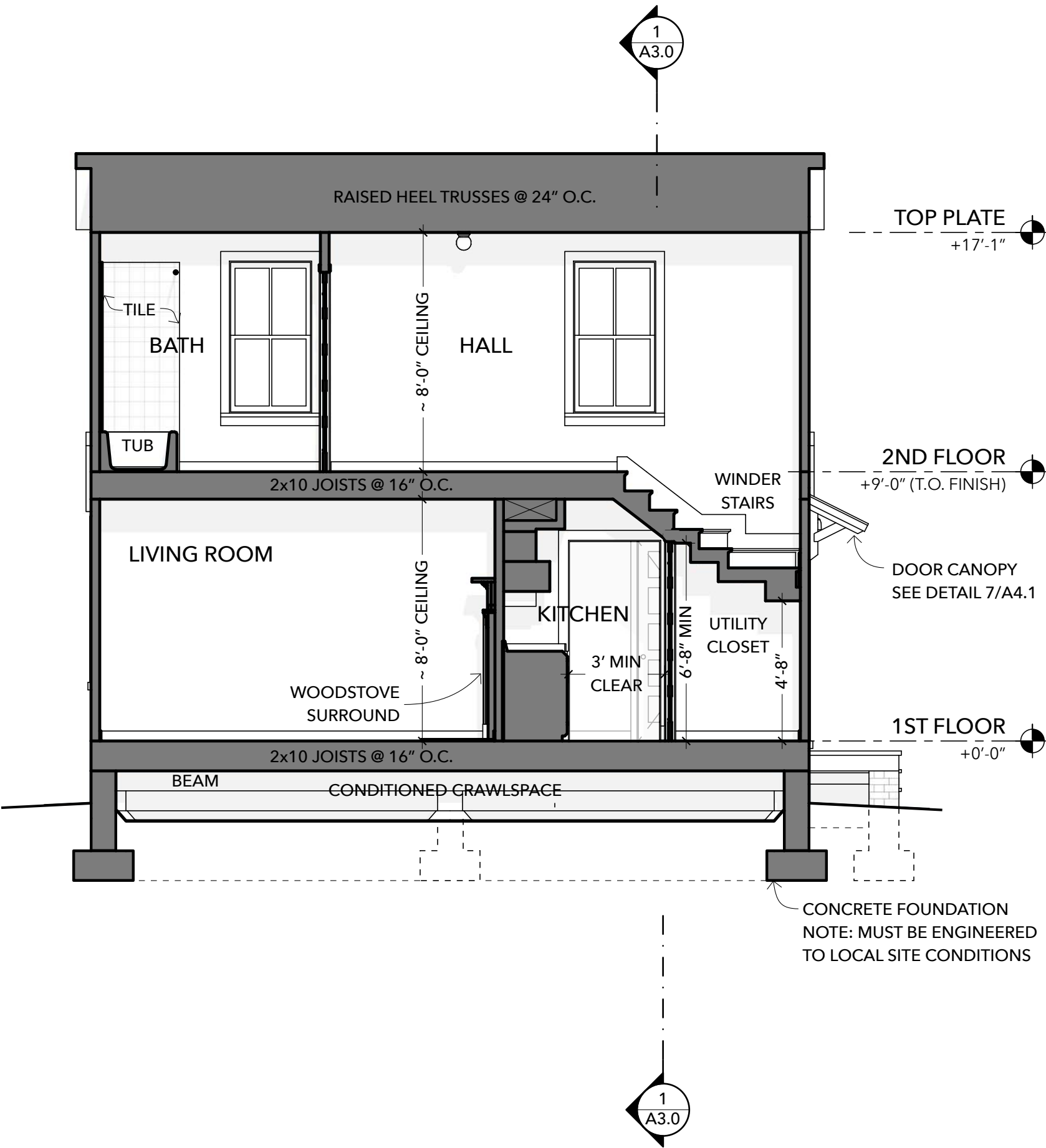
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SECTION NOTES

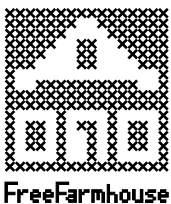
- 1. SEE TYPICAL SECTION DETAIL ON 8/A4.0
- 2. FOUNDATION TO BE ENGINEERED BASED ON SITE-SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS
- 3. WINDER STAIRS HAVE STRICT REQUIREMENTS. FOR MORE INFO, SEE 5-7/A4.0
- 4. WINDERS CAN BE BUILT AS A SERIES OF PLATFORMS. MAKE SURE TO USE 1-HR FIRE-RATED GYPSUM WALLBOARD SHEATHING UNDER THE STAIRS IN THE UTILITY CLOSET.
- 5. MAINTAIN 80" MIN HEAD CLEARANCE AT STAIRCASE.
- 6. CRAWLSPACE ACCESS CAN BE FROM THE UTILITY CLOSET.



1 TRANSVERSE SECTION
SCALE: 1/4" = 1'-0"



2 LONGITUDINAL SECTION
SCALE: 1/4" = 1'-0"



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SECTION VIEWS
A3.0



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THE ORIGINAL STARTER FARMHOUSE PLANS

† See A0.1 for more project history and credits

A4.1

MARK	ITEM	SIZE	MATERIAL	NOTES	MANUFACTURER / MODEL
F-00	BRICK	-	SMOOTH BRICK	SOLID RED COLOR, SAND-FACED, AVOID WIRE CUT OR "EXTRUDED" LOOK	OLD CAROLINA BRICK COMPANY
F-02	PORCH DECKING	1x4	PAINTED WOOD	TONGUE & GROOVE, UNPAINTED CEDAR PREFERRED, PAINTED WORKS FINE	RECLAIMED PREFERRED
F-04	PORCH COLUMNS	6x6	PAINTED WOOD	TURNUED PORCH POSTS (ALTERNATIVELY: 6x6 POSTS WITH CHAMFERED EDGES)	-
F-20	CLAPBOARD SIDING	6"	FIBER CEMENT	VINYL AND ALUMINUM SIDING ARE FORBIDDEN (DETAILS NEVER LOOK RIGHT).	JAMES HARDIE / ARTISAN LAP SIDING
F-22	EXT OPENING CASING	5-6"	FIBER CEMENT	FOR ALL SIDING, WOOD IS STILL AN OPTION. CEDAR PREFERRED.	HARDIPLANK OR 2x LUMBER
F-24	BED MOLDING	2.5", 4"	ROT-RESISTANT	PAINTED. EXTERIOR-GRADE. WOOD PREFERRED.	-
F-26	ASTRAGAL	1"	ROT-RESISTANT	PAINTED. VARIOUS EXTERIOR-GRADE MATERIAL OPTIONS ARE OKAY HERE	-
F-28	CROWN MOLDING	3-6"	ROT-RESISTANT	PAINTED. EXTERIOR-GRADE. WOOD PREFERRED.	-
F-40	STANDING SEAM ROOF	16" O.C.	GALVALUME	METAL. NO CORRUGATIONS. USE 5V PANELS FOR ECONOMICAL OPTION.	-
F-42	HALF-ROUND GUTTER	5" DIA	COPPER	GALV STEEL ALSO AN OPTION. ADJUST SIZE ACCORDING TO CLIMATE.	-
F-44	KITCHEN COUNTERTOP	1.5-2"	-	CHOOSE: QUARTZ, BUTCHER BLOCK, PORCELAIN TILE, GRANITE, SOAPSTONE	CHOICE BY HOMEOWNER.
F-48	BATHROOM COUNTERTOP	1.5-2"	-	CHOOSE: CERAMIC, QUARTZ, PORCELAIN, BUTCHER BLOCK, GRANITE, MARBLE	CHOICE BY HOMEOWNER.
F-50	HARDWOOD FLOOR	2-3" BDS	FINISH WOOD	TONGUE & GROOVE, STAINED. CREATE FLOOR PATTERNS AS DESIRED.	RECLAIMED PREFERRED.
F-52	FLOOR TILE	1-2" HEX	CERAMIC	HEXAGONAL PATTERN. WHITE COLOR, SMALLEST TILES PREFERRED	-
F-60	WALL TILE	4" SQ	CERAMIC	WHITE SUBWAY TILE, OR CHOICE BY HOMEOWNER.	-
F-62	BASE MOLDING	.5"x5"	FINISH WOOD	MAY INCLUDE DECORATIVE BASE CAP MOLDING.	-
F-64	INT OPENING CASING	.5"x5"	WOOD	PAINTED, WITH .1"-THICK PLINTH BLOCK AT BASE	-
F-68	BEADBOARD	1/2"	COMPOSITE PANEL	EXTERIOR GRADE BEADBOARD TO BE USED AT PORCH CEILING.	-
F-74	HANDRAIL	2"	FINISH WOOD	STAINED SAME COLOR AS FLOOR. MAKE SURE TO FOLLOW ALL REGULATIONS.	-
F-76	NEWEL POST (OPT)	4x4	WOOD	PAINTED, MODESTLY DECORATIVE. RECLAIMED/ANTIQUE PREFERRED.	-
F-78	BALUSTERS	2x2	WOOD	PAINTED, MODESTLY DECORATIVE. RECLAIMED/ANTIQUE PREFERRED.	-
F-79	CROWN MOLDING	4-6"	WOOD	PAINT-GRADE	-
F-80	WINDOW SHUTTERS	SEE NOTE	WOOD/COMPOSITE	SHUTTERS SHALL BE OPERABLE, AND SIZED TO EACH WINDOW.	- TIMBERLANE. OR BOARD & BATTEN.

1

MATERIALS SCHEDULE

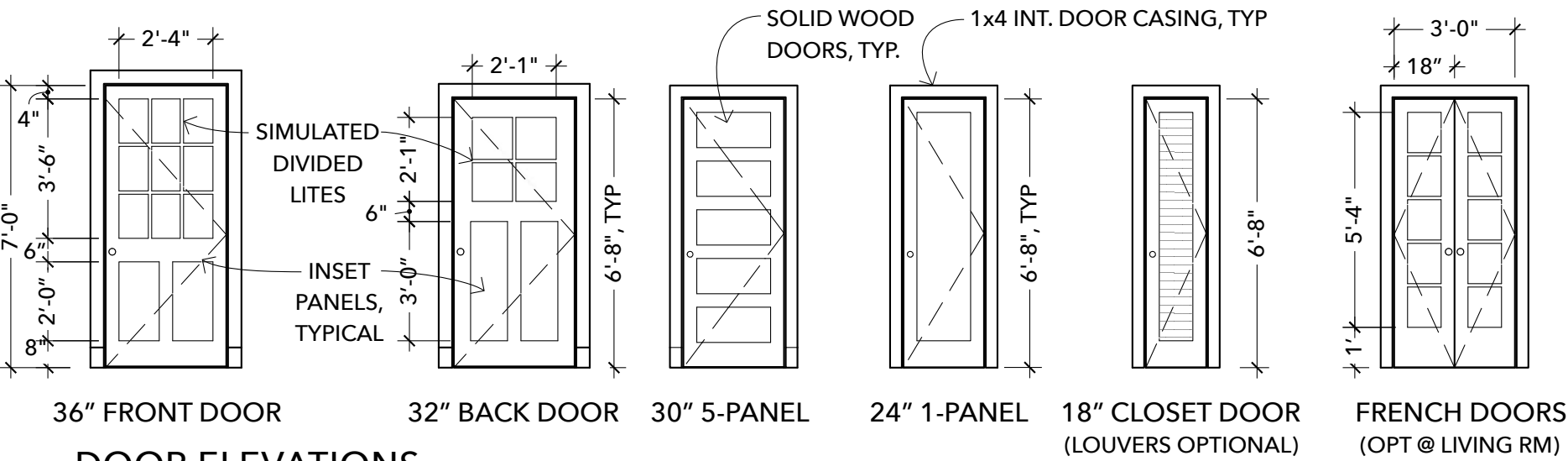
PRODUCTS ARE RECOMMENDATIONS (ADD "OR SIMILAR" TO EACH), BUT NOTES SHOULD BE HEDEED

MARK	ITEM	SIZE	NOTES	MANUFACTURER / MODEL
X-00	REFRIGERATOR	24" MAX WIDTH	ENERGY STAR, COUNTER DEPTH (24" DEPTH STRONGLY PREFERRED)	BLOMBERG BRFB1042SS
X-02	KITCHEN SINK	24" UNIT WIDTH	DOUBLE OR SINGLE BOWL, VITREOUS CHINA PREFERRED	HIGHPOINT COLLECTION OR SINKOLOGY FIRECLAY
X-04	RANGE / OVEN	24"x24"x36"	-	-
X-06	MICROWAVE/HOOD	24" WIDTH	FOR SIZE FLEXIBILITY, CABINET ABOVE THIS UNIT MAY BE OPEN SHELVING	FRIGIDAIRE UMV1422 US
X-08	WATER FAUCET	-	CHOICE BY HOMEOWNER.	-
X-12	DISHWASHER (OPT)	24" WIDTH	-	-
X-16	FLOOR CABINETS	VARIES	FOR AN ECONOMICAL OPTION, USE IKEA UNITS WITH CUSTOM DOORS.	IKEA / SEKTION
X-18	WALL CABINETS	VARIES	GLASS DOORS, WITH MANY PANES, PREFERRED. DOORS MAY BE BUILT DIY.	IKEA / SEKTION
X-20	TOILET	26"x18"	SINGLE BOWL, VITREOUS CHINA. STANDARD SIZE.	TOTO / ROWAN CST405MF OR EQUIVALENT
X-26	BATHROOM VANITY	30"(& 36") WIDE	CABINETS AND COUNTERTOP SURFACES TO BE CHOSEN BY HOMEOWNER.	-
X-30	BATHTUB	30x48	WALL TILE. GLASS DOORS OR CURTAIN. SEAT W/ SINGLE SLAB OF STONE	-
X-62	WASHER DRYER COMBO	30x30x72 MAX	VENTLESS, COMPACT (STACKED UNITS ALSO WORK IN JUNE & APRIL ALCOVES)	HAIER / HWD1600BW
X-68	WATER HEATER	17x15x5	WALL-MOUNTED, TANKLESS, INSTANT WATER HEATER.	STIEBEL ELTRON TEMPRA

2

FIXTURES SCHEDULE

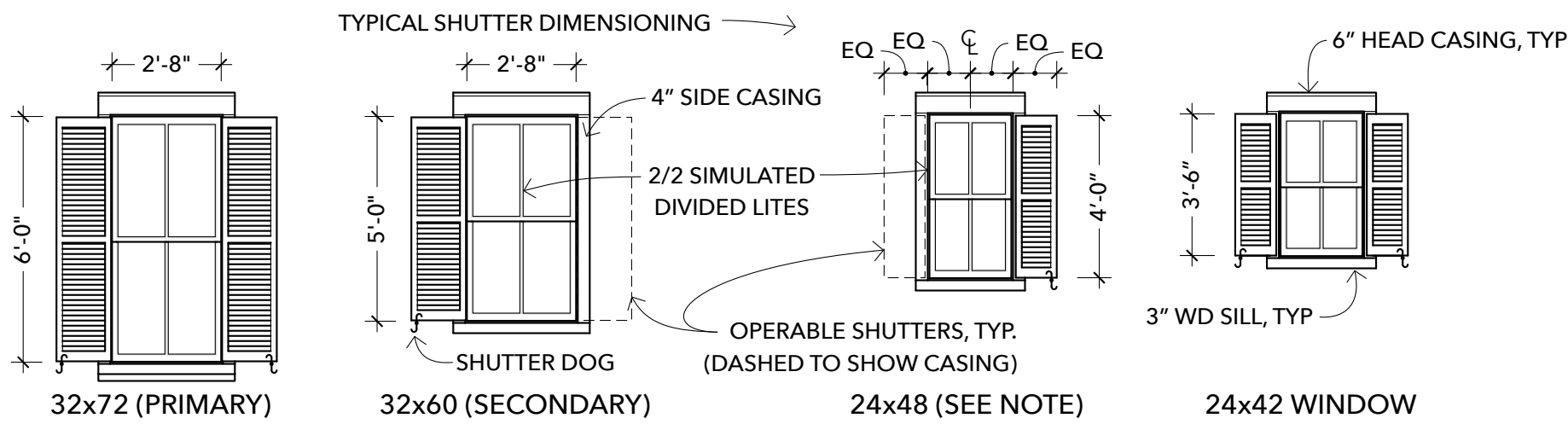
PRODUCTS ARE RECOMMENDATIONS (FREEFARMHOUSE.COM) ADD "OR SIMILAR" TO EACH.



5

DOOR ELEVATIONS

SCALE: 1/4" = 1'-0" NOTE: 32" CLEAR OPENING REQ'D AT FRONT DOOR (ACCOUNT FOR DOOR THICKNESS & HINGE).



6

WINDOW ELEVATIONS

SCALE: 1/4" = 1'-0" NOTE: 24x48 WINDOW MAY BE REPLACED BY 24x42 WINDOW. MAINTAIN HEADER HEIGHTS.

ITEM	MANUFACTURER / MODEL
INTERIOR CEILING LIGHT SCONCE	-
INTERIOR WALL LIGHT SCONCE	-
KIT. WASTE CABINET HARDWARE	-
KIT. SINK HARDWARE	-
SHOWER HARDWARE	-
BATH SINK HARDWARE	-
WINDOW SHUTTER HARDWARE	-
(OPT) PORCH HANGING LIGHT	-
(OPT) KITCHEN FLOORING (IF UNIQUE)	-

GINGERBREAD ORNAMENT OPTIONS: (**NOTE: VW = "VINTAGE WOODWORKS"**)

- PORCH BRACKET - VW COCKATOO 1194
- REPEATING CORNICE BRACKET (PORCH) - VW: EMMA 1560 (~6"x6")
- POST FACE BRACKET - VW "CUPID'S KEY" MEDIUM
- REPEATING CORNICE BRACKET (EAVE) - VW RILEY 1551
- GABLE WING - VW 4212
- CENTER DROP - 2x2, FINIAL (VW 182015)
- BARGEBOARD RUNNING TRIM - VW MARIPOSA 2229
- SAWN BALLUSTERS - VW SB5 2305
- PORCH RAILING - VW P-2 RAIL & SR2 SUBRAIL

SIMPLER ORNAMENT:

- REPEATING CORNICE BRACKET - VW: RILEY 1551

3

ADDITIONAL PRODUCT CHOICES

NOTE: MAY BE OMITTED, OR GIVEN MULTIPLE OPTIONS.

FINAL NOTES & FURTHER READING

ARCHITECTURAL PLANS NEVER HAVE ALL OF THE INFORMATION A BUILDER COULD NEED. BY PRACTICAL NECESSITY, PLANS ALWAYS OMIT SOME USEFUL IDEAS OR EXPLANATIONS. CODE DIAGRAMS CAN BE PLACED IN THE PLANS, AND SHOP DRAWINGS MAY BE INCLUDED – YET SUCH INFORMATION IS ALWAYS BETTER PRESENTED BY ALTERNATIVE METHODS. SO AS A SUPPLEMENT TO THESE DRAWINGS, HERE IS A LIST OF SOME USEFUL RESOURCES:

- IF THE DESIGN IS BEING MODIFIED**, ONE OF THESE (YOUR PICK) IS REQUIRED READING:
- "GET YOUR HOUSE RIGHT", BY MARIANNE CUSATO & BEN PENTREATH
 - "TRADITIONAL CONSTRUCTION PATTERNS", BY STEPHEN MOUZON & SUSAN HENDERSON

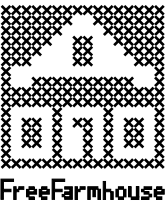
- FOR TECHNICAL INFORMATION AND GUIDANCE:**
- "SKETCHUP & LAYOUT FOR ARCHITECTURE", BY NICK SONDER (THE SOFTWARE USED HERE)
 - "RESIDENTIAL BUILDING CODES ILLUSTRATED", BY FRANCIS CHING AND OTHERS

- FOR A BIG PICTURE UNDERSTANDING:**
- "A PATTERN LANGUAGE", BY CHRISTOPHER ALEXANDER (GENERAL DESIGN PRINCIPLES)
 - "HOW BUILDINGS LEARN", BY STEWART BRAND (ADAPTABLE ARCHITECTURE STRATEGIES)

4

NOTES & ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

INCLUDING REQUIRED & RECOMMENDED READING

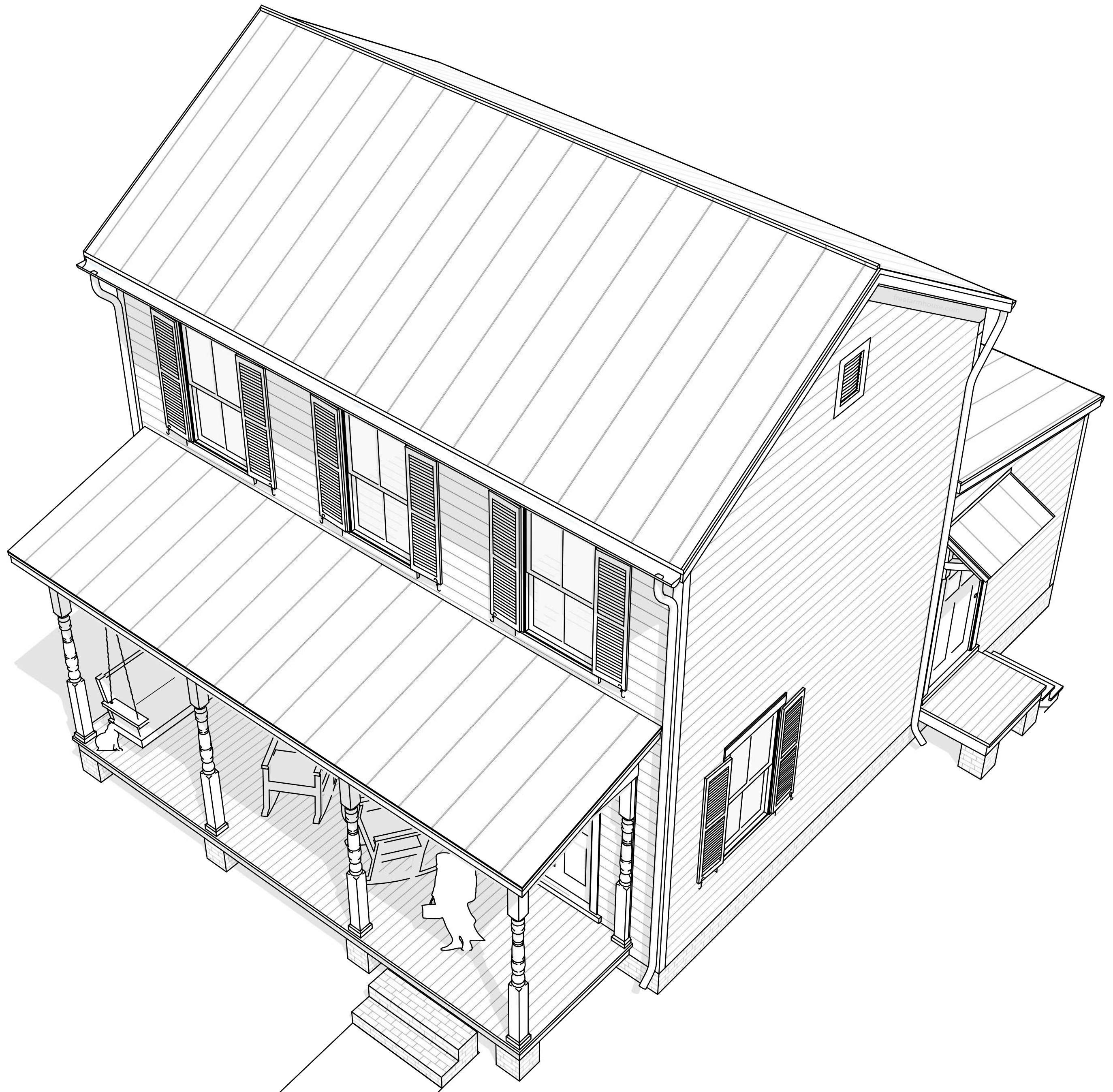


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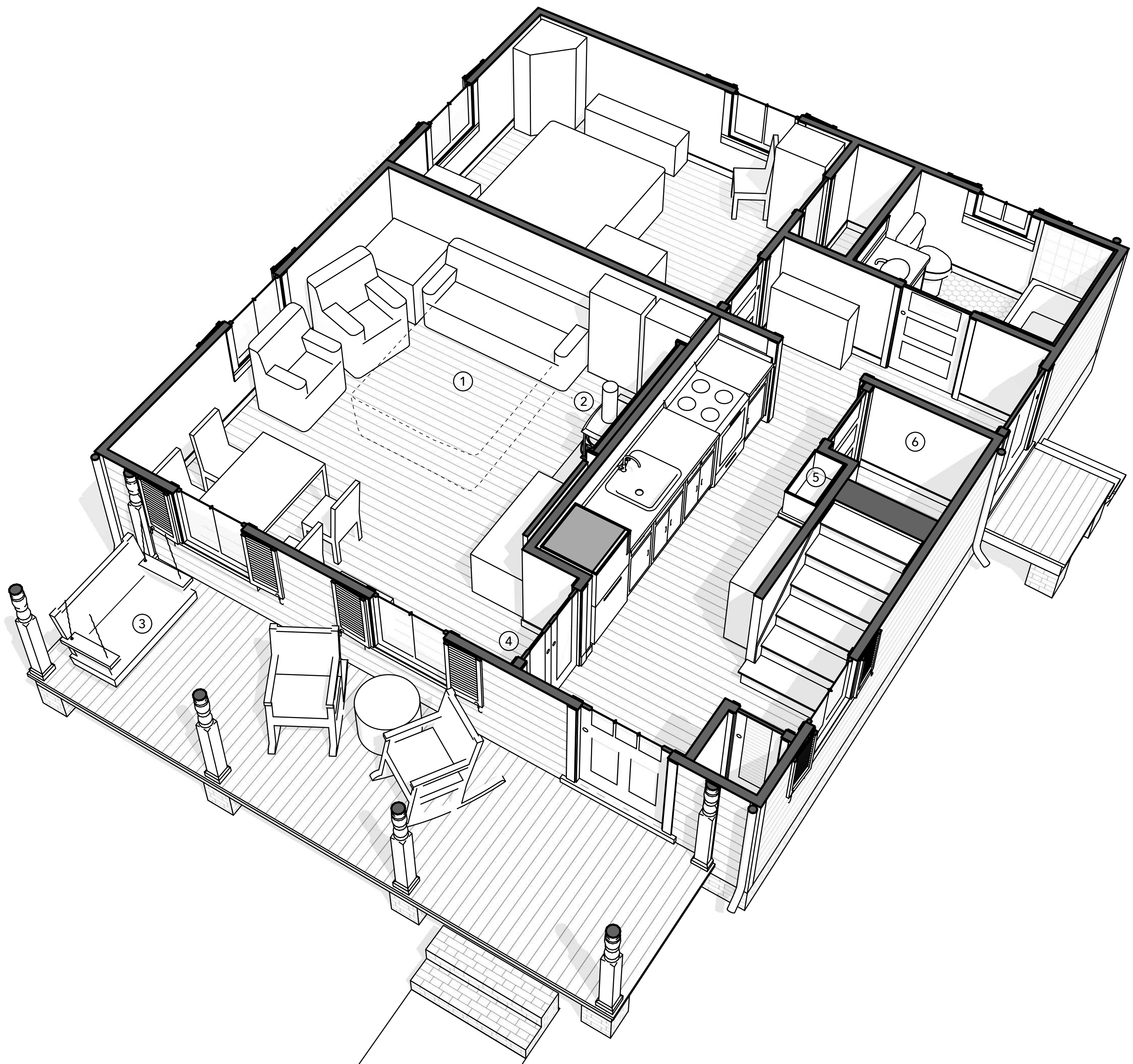
SCHEDULES
A5.0



The Starter Farmhouses are designed to grow over time. Though similar to my original open-source house design, Virginia is smaller– to fit more easily onto a narrow piece of land. Designed based on variations and options for additions, this tiny kernel can grow as you need it to– making it perfect for a starter home. Virginia's Farmhouse is the first of all the designs in my Starter Farmhouse series.

VIRGINIA'S FARMHOUSE
DESIGN OVERVIEW
JAY OSBORNE

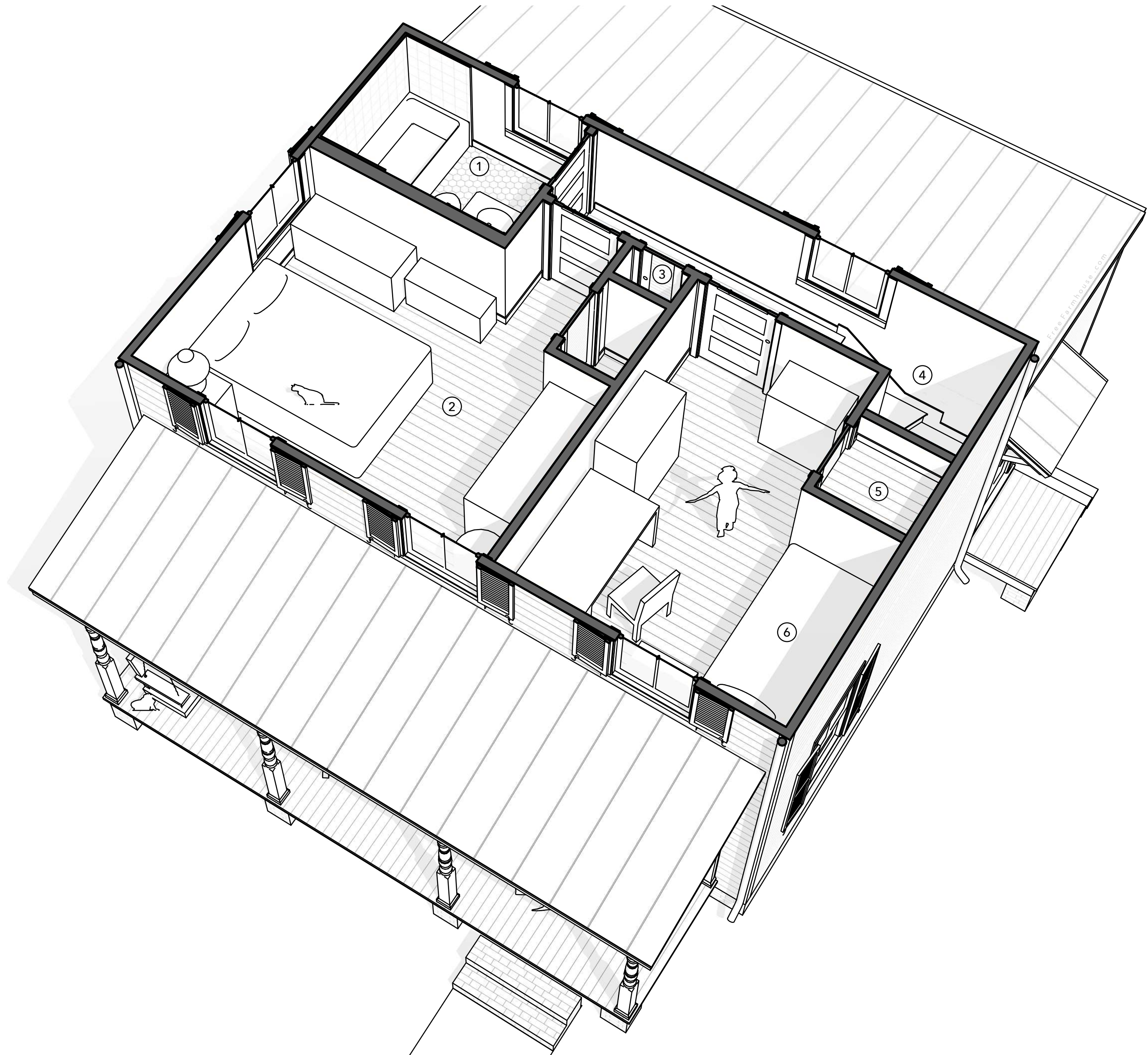
Each of the Starter Farmhouse designs will begin with a 16x24 primary massing – about 750 square feet at the smallest. This version of Virginia's Farmhouse includes a bedroom suite addition. With that rear addition, Virginia is still only 970 square feet– but you can enlarge it by choosing from many possible additions. Eventually, I'll create a system with many interchangeable additions.



The lower level of this house is arranged in a “hall and parlor” layout— classic for an old house. Despite the modern fashion for eliminating interior walls, it’s worth remembering that walls are functional. They give privacy, so the spaces can be used by more people for more separate purposes. **(1)** With a sofa bed, this living room can work perfectly as a guest bedroom. **(2)** This woodstove is optional.

VIRGINIA’S FARMHOUSE
DOWNSTAIRS PLAN
 JAY OSBORNE

(3) The porch is big enough for rocking chairs and a swing. **(4)** The living room can also be an office or guest room, but these french doors will usually be open. **(5)** Pantry cabinet could be open shelves instead. **(6)** Head height clearances are critical. Changing the stairs may cause many afterthoughts. If a basement stair is included below, the kitchen storage cabinet (pantry) must be sacrificed for that.



(1) This is the only bathroom, and is the minimum conventional size. A house this small does not warrant a second upstairs bathroom, but one is included in a rear addition. **(2)** The main bedroom is about 120 square feet in size, which is a minimum requirement in some places. **(3)** The linen closet might instead be a utility chase used for a chimney pipe, or for ductwork (or for an air handling unit).

VIRGINIA'S FARMHOUSE
UPSTAIRS PLAN
 JAY OSBORNE

(4) Winder stairs are strictly regulated by code. Now they're safer but difficult to build. Future versions of this design may be 18' wide just to simplify the staircase. **(5)** Head clearances are critical, so this closet has a raised platform for the stairs below. **(6)** The bedroom alcove needs enough space for a bed (7 feet, which may be required by code). With head heights, this significantly limits the stairs.

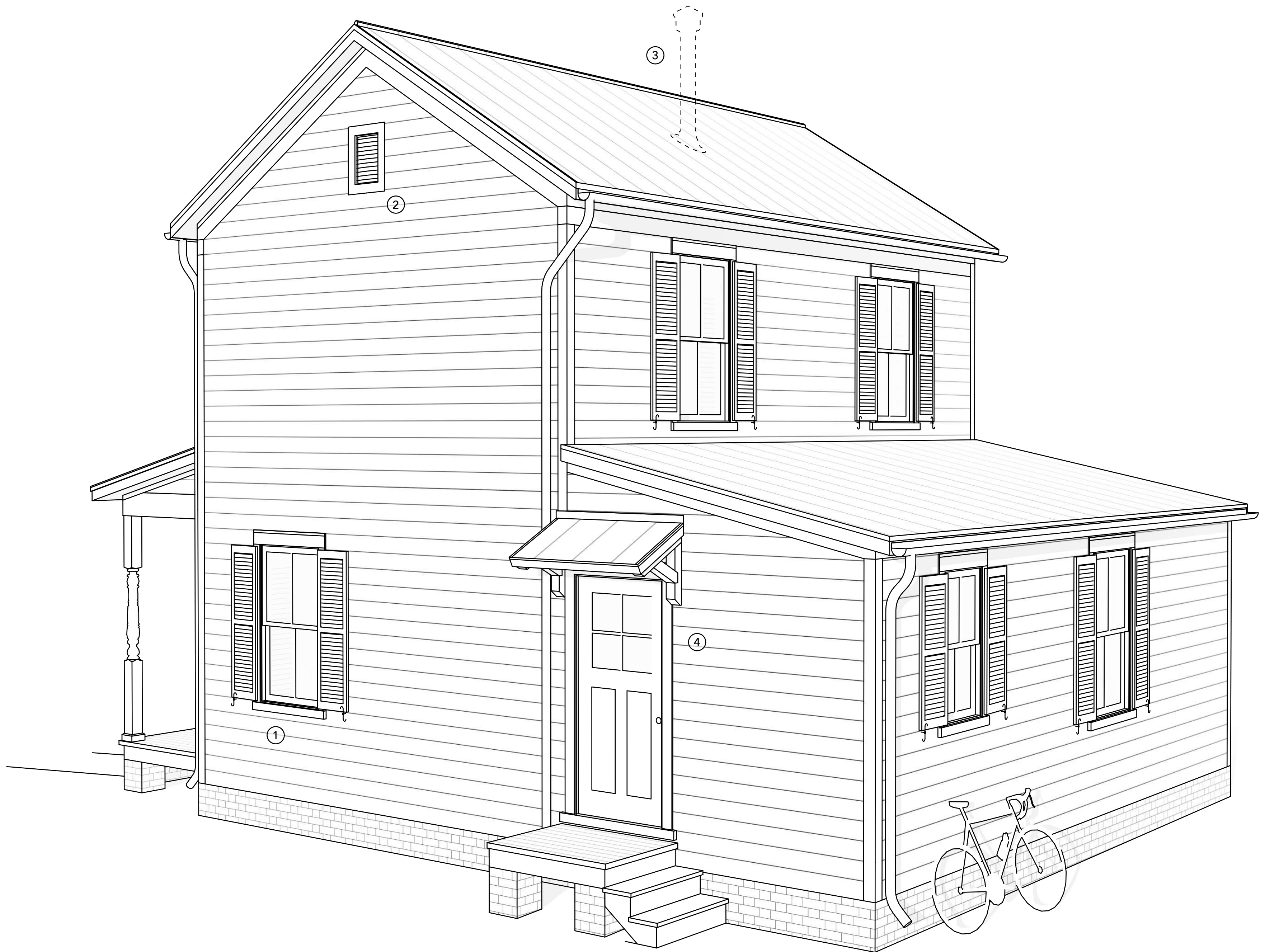


With a front facade that is only 24 feet wide, Virginia's Farmhouse can fit in many old towns. The design is prioritized around being simple and economical, and to be able to have different options for additions and materials in the drawing set.

(1) Real window shutters are functional. If cost is an issue, don't compromise with screw-on or vinyl fakes. Instead, just omit the shutters until you can do them right.

VIRGINIA'S FARMHOUSE
FRONT OF THE HOUSE
 JAY OSBORNE

(2) A note of caution: Even though this is perhaps the simplest eave imaginable, builders tend to mangle historical details with their infamous "pork chop eaves", which are both tasteless and modern. To make a new house look old, builders must unlearn bad habits. **(3)** The porch roof can have its slope reduced to about 2.5/12, a common porch roof slope in old houses (corresponding to a 1/5 pitch).



This version of Virginia's Farmhouse has a rear addition with a bedroom suite on the first floor. Other options for this rear addition will be possible, but it's important to note that the design could start without it. It might be added over time to reduce the upfront cost of the house, or to give more time for decisions. **(1)** This window brightens the staircase and kitchen. Yet it could be omitted.

VIRGINIA'S FARMHOUSE
BACK OF THE HOUSE
 JAY OSBORNE

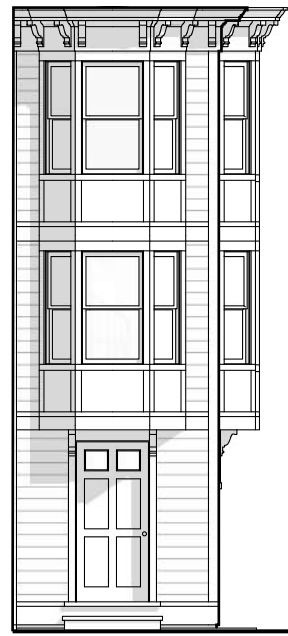
(2) The attic vent is built much like a louvered shutter. **(3)** A chimney of some sort is required if there's a woodstove, but you have many options. A metal chimney pipe allows some flexibility in the placement, but it will need to be at least two feet higher than the roof ridge. It might not look great from the front of the house. **(4)** The back door's tiny window greatly improves the interior lighting.



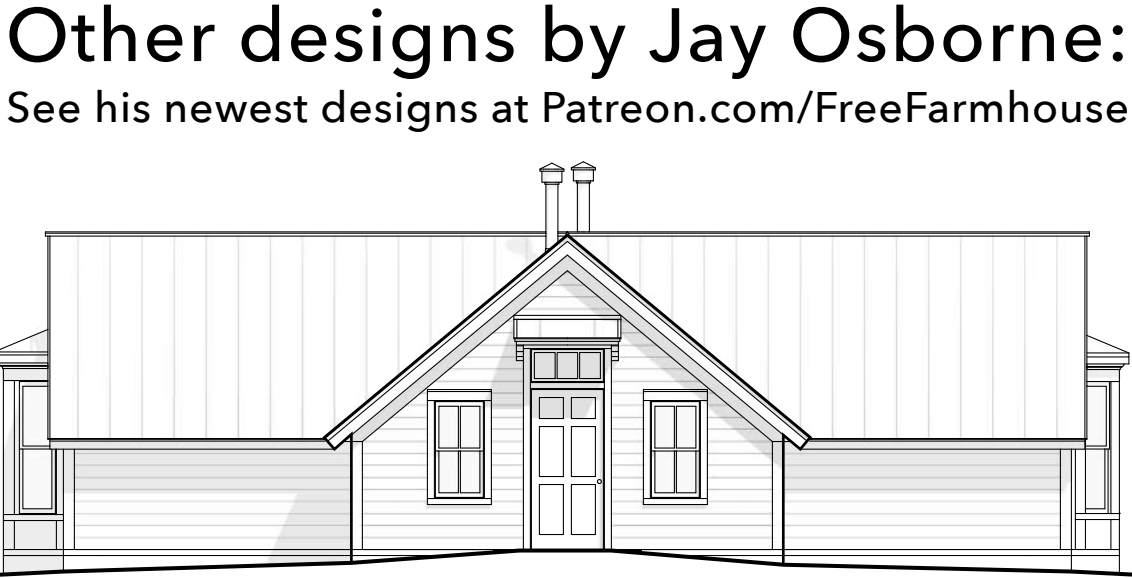
In small houses, staircases take a disproportionately large amount of space, and are relatively expensive to build. However, over the long run, two-story houses do better than one-story houses since they have half as much foundation and roof. Over time, roofs and foundations can be very costly to maintain. **(1)** It might be best to omit the coat closet at the front door, and include a wardrobe instead.

VIRGINIA'S FARMHOUSE
SECTION VIEW
 JAY OSBORNE

(2) This shows a crawlspace, but if a slab foundation is used, the height can be reduced by 2 feet—perhaps necessary for any overly-strict building height limits. **(3)** Head clearances around the staircase are a key factor in the house's design. **(4)** A utility closet fits underneath the stairs, and can have a compact laundry machine. Alternatively, by stacking staircases, it's possible to have a basement.



Bicycle
Townhouse



First Halfstory House



Canadian Farmhouse



Mae's Backyard Farmhouse



Julie's Backyard Farmhouse



Australian Farmhouse



Eastern Farmhouse



April's Backyard Farmhouse



June's Backyard Farmhouse



Southern Farmhouse



Thoreau Cabin



Lone Star Farmhouse



Western Farmhouse



Virginia's Starter Farmhouse



Georgia's Starter Farmhouse



Caroline's Starter Farmhouse



Marilyn's Starter Farmhouse



Carriage House